

Disturbed

Film script for a gothic psychological thriller

by

Francis Dove

Copyright © 2018 Cartheur All rights reserved. This book or any portion thereof may not be reproduced or used in any manner whatsoever without the express written permission of the publisher except for the use of brief quotations in a book review or other advertising medium. For any alternate media reproduction or licensing of the content herein contact the publisher.

Disturbed

First Edition, 2018

Cartheur

support@cartheur.com

EXT. A hilly sun-drenched landscape. Early evening. Heavy CLOUDS are on the horizon. We SEE a stone CHURCH across a yellow-brown FIELD. Men in robes in a procession file through the DOOR. They hold CANDLES and one grips a CHALICE. SUBTITLES which read "SUMMER 1836."

Cut to:

INT. Church. The ROBED MEN walk down a HALLWAY, turn and face an ALTAR where a partially decomposed BODY lies. Three Robed Men move behind the ALTAR. They whisper to each other (ad lib) and one points to the BODY—they cease their conversation.

1st ROBED MAN

Let us begin.

The ROBED MEN begin to CHANT phrases in Latin, 1st Robed Man comes forward bearing the CHALICE. He stands over the BODY and utters a prayer. 2nd Robed Man comes forward and presents the AMULET to the throng and places it around the NECK of the BODY having the AMULET lie exactly upon the heart. 1st Robed Man raises the CHALICE and looks up at the CEILING.

Cut to:

INT. Church/Backroom. We SEE a pregnant WOMAN lying on a blanket ready to give birth. 3rd Robed Man with his hood removed is assisting her. She lets out painful screams which echo through the CHURCH.

Cut to:

INT. Church/Frontroom. The CHANTING becomes more intensified, 2nd Robed Man begins to read from an ancient TEXT, THUNDER rumbles in the distance. The BODY begins to stir.

Cut to:

INT. Backroom. The woman readies to give birth. 3rd Robed Man is helping her along.

Cut to:

INT. Church/Frontroom. A few more Latin phrases are spoken, increasing in volume. THUNDER shakes the foundation of the CHURCH and LIGHTNING surrounds. The

BODY opens its crackled eyes and begins to sit up.

Cut to:

INT. Backroom. The woman gives birth and the 3rd Robed Man picks up the newborn. He washes it in a BOWL of water beside him. LIGHTNING flashes can be seen through the WINDOWS.

3rd ROBED MAN

This is the first Beledire to be borne into this new land.

The woman smiles and wraps the child in a blanket.

Cut to:

INT. Frontroom. The body has completely sat up and the AMULET is emulating a fierce light.

1st ROBED MAN

My friends. Flammis acrebus, Kutulu eliason! Welcome our new disciple.

WINDOWS shatter and dozens of plainly dressed people storm the CHURCH. GUNS are fired and the ROBED MEN fall.

Cut to:

INT. Backroom of the CHURCH. The shots and screams are heard. The 3rd Robed Man gets up. The woman grabs his ARM.

WOMAN

Don't, my love. Our son will need a father.

The 3rd Robed Man shakes his head.

3rd ROBED MAN

They cannot leave us alone. They follow us endlessly. But it will never be this way again.

3rd Robed Man walks over to the CHILD and takes him from the woman. He holds him close to his CHEST and kisses him on the top of his HEAD.

3rd ROBED MAN

My son, someone will avenge what has happened this night. You must keep in your heart the story of this night. There will be one, one who will bring us back to life.

The 3rd Robed Man gives the CHILD back to the woman. He kisses her and runs out of the ROOM.

Cut to:

The 3rd Robed Man is seen running out into the MELEE. Screams of terror and panic are heard as the CHURCH is set afire. The newly-animated decomposed BODY is shot and stomped upon while others seize the AMULET and set it down upon the stone FLOOR. Pull CAMERA in on the AMULET. The butt of a GUN comes down and strikes the AMULET. A sickening metallic SOUND is heard as the AMULET is broken into five pieces. 3rd Robed Man faces 1st VILLAGER and fights with him, the woman is SEEN looking on from the safety of the back room. A PITCHFORK is grabbed and the 3rd Robed Man is impaled by it. The woman shrieks. The 1st Villager eyes her and comes after her. She turns to run but as he approaches the DOORWAY, he is stopped by the 2nd Robed Man who he fights with.

Cut to:

EXT. Church. A WINDOW is broken. The Woman kicks the GLASS from the sill and climbs out carrying a crying child. She runs off into the WOODS. We SEE the CHURCH in the distance. It is ablaze. Loud claps of THUNDER are heard intermixed with screams of terror—a flash of LIGHTNING blinds the CAMERA.

Cut to:

EXT. A high-school Parking lot. Day. Faded screams and THUNDERCLAPS are heard as the breeze blowing through the TREES slowly out-volumes it. We SEE two teenagers, Alex Preston and Ben Dannon, sitting in a car under the TREE. We SEE they are passing a JOINT between them. Subtitles: PRESENT DAY.

Cut to:

INT. Car. We SEE a fragment of the AMULET around Alex's neck.

ALEX

So what do you think? Good stuff?

(Passes joint)

BEN

(Takes a hit)

Yeah, great.

(Passes joint)

Ben tries to hold the smoke in but coughs and exhales it. He chokes a bit and gazes at Alex who is smiling and nodding. Ben takes notice of the AMULET.

BEN

Where'd you get that?

ALEX

From Steve-O, he can get the greatest...

BEN

No, the thing you're wearing. I haven't seen that before.

ALEX

This? Oh, my father gave me this a long time ago. I found it the other day while rummaging through my room. Totally forgot about it. I'd just thought I'd wear it, it's a good luck charm.

Cut to:

EXT. Car. We SEE clouds of smoke billowing from the CAR. CAMERA moves in close and comes to rest at the window level of the CAR.

Cut to:

Alex is in the middle of taking a hit, while he's exhaling, the principal, Mr. Taff, pops into the car's WINDOW.

ALEX

Oh, shit!

BEN

What?!

He looks over his shoulder at Mr. Taff. Ben smiles.

BEN

Howdy, Mr. Taff.

TAFF

Well, well, what do we have here? If it isn't Mr. Dannon and Mr. Preston. Preparing for another grueling day of classes are we?

ALEX

Uh,...Mr. Taff, we can explain.

TAFF

You can tell me the whole story on our way to my office. Now follow me please.

Ben shoots Alex a distressed look. Alex shrugs his shoulders. They get out of the CAR.

ALEX

Mr. Taff, this isn't what it looks like. See, we weren't smoking weed or anything, Ben here has this rolling tobacco he got from his dad and, you know, I have to admit it does kind of smell like weed but it wasn't weed at all was it Ben?

Ben stares at Alex and shakes his head. They enter the SCHOOL and go into the OFFICE.

Cut to:

Mr. Taff's office, they pass his secretary.

ALEX

So you see what I'm saying Mr. Taff? You've just misunderstood everything. We weren't smoking weed at all.

Alex starts to break a smile and looks at Ben. Ben looks extremely nervous and shakes his head so to discourage Alex from laughing. They sit down.

BEN

Mr. Taff, we're really sorry, it won't happen again.

TAFF

Drugs are against school policy Mr. Dannon, you should know that.

Alex's SMILE widens, then he breaks into hysterics.

BEN

Give us a break Mr. Taff, please?

ALEX

Don't kiss up to him Ben, let him throw us in detention, oh boy!

BEN

I'm really sorry Mr. Taff.

TAFF

(Alex is laughing in the background, Taff raises his voice.) And taking drugs is not the solution to your problems. You won't see things any better.

BEN

I know that but...

TAFF

You have to learn that this is not the way to go about life.

ALEX

Don't you think that's funny Ben? (Continues laughing)

BEN

(Looking very distressed) I know, now I've learned that. I pick things up fast.

TAFF

But the only way to learn is to be punished for your wrongs, so you won't be inclined to do them again. (In a loud voice) Mr. Preston!

Alex quits laughing and looks at Ben and Mr. Taff, he gets a sudden serious look in his FACE.

TAFF

Finished?

Alex quietly nods and wipes tears from his EYES.

TAFF

I want the two of you to empty your pockets.

Ben and Alex stand and place their possessions on the DESK. Taff takes Alex's pack of cigarettes, looks through it.

TAFF

Three marijuana cigarettes.

ALEX

Three? But there were five there this morning, eh, Ben?

Alex breaks into laughter and Ben looks cross. Taff pushes a BUTTON on his DESK.

TAFF

Ms. Rosewood? Could you get me Mr. Preston and Mr. Dannon's parents where they can be reached?

Taff pulls out two suspension slips and begins to fill them out.

ALEX

Suspension? That's not fair!

TAFF

Now, I'm going to suspend the two of you for three days. I don't want to do this but I can't think of any other way to make you see what's important around here. Go home and think your priorities over.

Cut to:

Alex and Ben standing in front of the OFFICE.

BEN

My dad's going to kill me. (The dismissal bell RINGS)

ALEX

Think positive, this little vacation will probably do us some good.

BEN

This isn't funny anymore, you're not funny, you got me busted.

ALEX

Hey, take it easy Ben man, you're in this as much as I am.

BEN

Isn't much to say for me.

Alex sees someone he knows walking down the HALL—it is Steve-O.

ALEX

Don't look now.

Ben turns and sees Steve-O.

BEN

Shit. This is all I need.

STEVE-O

Hello there guys. What's goin' on?

BEN

Go away, Steve-O.

STEVE -O

What the hell? You get in trouble or something?

BEN

Got busted with that shit you sold Alex.

STEVE -O

Ain't my fault you got caught with it. What'd ol' Taff give ya?

BEN

He suspended us.

Steve-O sees the AMULET around Alex's neck.

STEVE-O

What's that?

He comes in close and grasps the AMULET.

STEVE-O

(Talking to the AMULET) Do you know what this is, Alex?

ALEX

Just something my father gave me.

STEVE-O

No, do you know what this IS?

BEN

(Looks blankly at Alex) No, what is it?

STEVE-O

It's a fragment of a larger necromancy amulet...(the bell RINGS)...it hasn't been seen
for almost...geez...190 years.

Taff sees the three of them talking in the HALL and comes out to see what's going on.
Steve-O sees him.

STEVE-O

I'd better go, old Ironsides is on his way out.

ALEX

(Looking confused)

STEVE-O

I have to tell you the story of that piece...and soon.

ALEX

Alright. See ya.

Steve-O turns to leave, Ben and Alex leave the SCHOOL.

TAFF

Are you lost, Mr. Daily?

STEVE-O

No, just helping a couple of friends.

Cut to:

Alex and Ben exiting the SCHOOL. Alex sees his Mom sitting in her car at the curb.

BEN

What do you think about what Steve-O said?

ALEX

I don't know. Pretty trippy. Wish me luck.

Ben nods his head. Alex walks to the car and gets in. He opens his MOUTH as if to say something, his mother cuts him off.

MOM

(Driving off) Don't you even open your mouth!...I'm so mad at you...you can't seem to stay out of trouble can you?! And I thought those years at the boarding school would have done you some good but noooo!

Cut to:

The front of the SCHOOL. Ben's father drives up in a police car. Ben quietly gets in.

MIKE DANNON

Looks like you've done it again, Ben. What's this town going to think when they hear the police chief's son was suspended for smoking dope? I don't think it'll go over too well, do you? It's your life son and I try not to interfere but you know this isn't the first time Alex has gotten you into trouble.

Ben nods his head.

MIKE

What do you think he'll pull next? He has a serious drug problem. Think about that.

Cut to:

Alex and Mom driving up the hill to their house.

MOM

Tell me where I've gone wrong with you? Huh? Tell me! Where have I gone wrong

with you? I've tried to raise you normal, God knows I've tried my best. I've tried everything in my power to make you good. I can't take it anymore Alex! (Long pause)

Now, what do I do with you? What do you think, hmm?

ALEX

(Under his breath) I don't know.

MOM

Oh, that's great, you don't know? YOU don't know. Well, keep yourself mister. (She huffs loudly and quickly looks out the car WINDOWS) Ooh, just wait until your father hears this—he'll go through the roof!

ALEX

(Under his breath) He's not my father.

MOM

(Looks astonished) What?! What did you say about Tom?

ALEX

Nothing.

Cut to:

Ben and his father, Mike, in the CAR.

MIKE

It's bad enough to have one psychopath running around but now I'm going to have to baby sit my seventeen year-old son. The work is going to be that much harder. Ben, if you don't stop going around with Alex, he's going to get you into far deeper trouble.

BEN

I don't know if he gets me into...

MIKE

Ben, listen to yourself. Don't defend him, he's a bad seed. He's on his way down and he's looking to drag you with him if you let him. Do me a favor, Ben? Don't hang out with Alex Preston any longer.

Mike and Ben pull up to their house.

Cut to:

Alex and Mom driving up the hill. Shot of TREES and SKY. Shot of Alex silently looking out the WINDOW. They turn off onto a gravel road, go past Mr. Gilman's house, then to theirs. (Establish the HOUSE is on the top of a mountain far removed from people save the other two HOUSES.)

MOM

I don't know how I can even show my face in town. I'm just sick to my stomach.

Alex and Mom get out of the car and walk to the HOUSE. WIND picks up and shakes the trees, a few dreamy notes of music can be heard. FADE OUT.

FADE IN. EXT. Alex's house. INT. We see mom in kitchen throwing her purse on the counter and ascending stairs to Alex's room.

Cut to:

Alex's room. Alex is sleeping. He's mumbling incoherently. FOOTSTEPS on the stairs can be heard. Mom open the DOOR.

MOM

(Yelling) Alex! Get up! You hear me, get up right now!

ALEX

(Stirs) What?

MOM

Throw me your keys right now. You are grounded until further notice. I have to go to work. You have work to do. (Alex climbs back into bed) I want the stack of logs outside chopped. The dishes washed, the livingroom swept...and straighten this room...I know you have homework to do. And when I get home, I want to see what you've done, I want to see that you haven't been sitting on your butt all day. Do I make myself clear?

Alex mumbles.

MOM

Do I make myself clear?!

ALEX

Yes.

MOM

Tom is going to be home tonight so you'd better start figuring out what you're going to tell him.

ALEX

Yeah, yeah.

She closes the DOOR. Her FOOTSTEPS are heard on the stairs.

EXT. The people who live in the neighborhood are leaving for work showing that Alex is isolated.

Cut to:

Ben's house. Ben walks into the KITCHEN. There's a NOTE on the refrigerator that reads:

'I meant what I said last night, I want you to think about it and I'll deal with you when I get home. -Dad'

Ben tears the NOTE off, crumples it up and throws it away. He looks around the KITCHEN. He opens the REFRIGERATOR and pulls out a bottle of SODA and pours some into a coffee CUP.

Cut to:

Alex in dirty jeans and a shirt in the KITCHEN. He pours himself a CUP of coffee and sits at the TABLE. He begins to smoke. He picks up the NEWSPAPER and glances at the headlines; they proclaim a serial killer is on the loose. Alex sets the paper down on the table in front of him—the AMULET is seen fastened about his neck. He frowns at his cigarette, extinguishes it, and searches for another section of the paper. He then throws the whole thing down. The NEWSPAPER lands headline up. He walks over to the PIANO and begins to play a lazy tune. He stops then goes into the LIVINGROOM, plops down on the COUCH and thumbs through a MAGAZINE. He tosses the MAGAZINE and goes upstairs.

He goes into his ROOM, CAMERA pans and looks at his room. (Carefully places things to make Alex look diverse/learned, books, posters of rock stars, comic books) There is a PHOTO of Alex's mom and his step-father Tom. CLOSE UP of the PHOTO as Alex kneels at a dresser and opens a drawer, he sifts through some underwear and pulls out an old PHOTO of Alex and his father camping. CAMERA is looking at the PHOTO from Alex's point-of-view. (Alex appears to be about ten years old.) They are posing with a RABBIT. Silent LIGHTNING flashes across the face of the picture.

Cut to:

Alex's FACE. He is looking down with a straight face. He looks off out the WINDOW. He rubs his forehead and frantically runs his fingers through his hair. He tosses the picture back into the drawer.

He closes the drawer, turns and goes to a pile of clothes in the middle of the room. He roots through the pile and pulls out a greasy pair of JEANS. He searches the POCKETS and pulls out a small piece of folded aluminum FOIL. He looks at the piece of FOIL then looks about the ROOM.

ALEX

Clean it up, eh? I'll clean the whole place, that's what I'll do.

Alex opens a CLOSET door, STUFF falls out. He kicks at the pile of clothes until most of them are in the CLOSET. He tries to close the CLOSET DOOR but can't manage. He gives up as the clothes are hanging out blocking the closure of the DOOR.

He walks downstairs to the LIVINGROOM, turns on some music and sits on the COUCH. He unfolds the small aluminum PACKAGE. He eyes the two small pieces of paper with happy faces printed upon them and sets them on the ENDTABLE.

ALEX

Not supposed to take them alone, Alex.

He gets up and meanders around the LIVINGROOM.

ALEX

But I'm so fucking bored.

He looks at the two SMILEY FACES.

ALEX

What else is there to do?

He walks over and puts the two pieces of paper under his TONGUE. He looks around then swallows. He plops down on the COUCH and leans back.

ALEX

This is gonna be a great day, I can feel it.

Cut to:

Ben's house. He's watching TELEVISION broadcasting reports of a severe storm nearing the area and eating a TV dinner. Lightning flashes outside and quiet thunder rumbles. Ben finishes his meal (CAMERA SEES he's eaten Saulsbury steak, potatoes, and a brownie of a TV dinner) and goes to the KITCHEN. He looks at the CLOCK over the refrigerator—10 17AM.

BEN

I wonder what Alex's doing?

He turns off the TELEVISION, picks up the PHONE, and prepares to call Alex.

Cut to:

Alex walking around his house. He walks over to Tom's DESK in the library and yanks at some of the drawers. One opens and Alex extracts a small book, which looks like a JOURNAL. He starts to open it and the PHONE rings. He drops the JOURNAL. Alex walks into the kitchen and answers the PHONE.

ALEX

Hello?

BEN

Alex. It's Ben. What's going on? My dad is all pissed off.

ALEX

Same here. My mom chewed my ass. You know, we're lucky Taff didn't find the LSD in my pocket. I just dropped two hits and I'm already trippin'.

BEN

Two hits?! Are you crazy? That shit was double-dipped.

ALEX

What? You mean to tell me.....

BEN

If you think you're trippin' now...

ALEX

(All of a sudden as if he were hit on the back of the head) Oh, shit, I'm trippin'. (He looks paranoid) Oh, shit.

BEN

Listen Alex, take a deep breath and relax...I tell you, just put on some Pink Floyd and ride it out.

ALEX

I don't think I can breathe that deeply besides, I've got a serious problem.

BEN

What's that?

ALEX

I don't own any Pink Floyd. (Heavy tone of MUSIC) Oh, shit what was that?

BEN

What?

Cut to:

Alex hearing SOUND FX and things are looking warped. A loud rumble of thunder shakes the house and lightning dances across the floor.

ALEX

Oh, shit. The kitchen. The ceiling's coming down! Help Ben, I'm losing it! It's never done this before!

BEN

What? You've dropped acid before, right?

ALEX

Sure...sort of.....Ben you gotta help me, man, I'm freakin'

BEN

Don't fight it.

ALEX

I'm losin' it Ben. (He looks down at the NEWSPAPER on the floor, he sees the serial killer headline) Oh, God, he's gonna get me!

BEN

Just keep cool. I'm coming up.

ALEX

You've gotta help me. Hello? Hello?!?!

BEN

Yeah, man, keep cool. I'm leaving now. (Ben hangs up)

Cut to:

Alex finding the phone cradle and hanging up. He appears panic stricken. He grabs his head and squeezes it. He aimlessly walks around the house observing the different FX. The acid trip is becoming more and more vivid.

Cut to:

POLICE STATION: Chief Mike Dannon enters.

MIKE

Anything yet?

OFFICER

We're putting everything we have into it.

MIKE

That's not what I want to hear.

Mike looks at a wall map of the county. PINS are placed where the killer has struck. He looks over it carefully.

OFFICER DAILY

I heard from my boy that Ben was suspended from school.

MIKE

Good news sure travels fast around here doesn't it? (He turns back to the MAP) I can't get it Frank, what is the connection here with this psycho. All killers have a pattern.

What is it?

OFFICER DAILY

Something will develop.

Cut to:

INT. Steve Daily's house (Steve-O). Steve-O is sitting at a desk in his room. He is staring blankly at the wide variety of OCCULT BOOKS on his shelf before him. He picks up a PENCIL and scribbles a drawing on a scrap piece of paper. The DRAWING resembles the fragment of the AMULET that Alex was wearing. Steve-O sighs and SCRIBBLES some more.

STEVE-O

I know I've seen this before somewhere.

He taps his PENCIL on the desk and draws his thumb across the shelf of books.

Cut to:

Ben driving up the mountain talking to himself. THUNDER is heard in the distance.

BEN

(To himself) Two hits of double-dip, Alex? Damn, I knew I shouldn't have left that shit with him.

Cut to:

Alex. Something appears out of the corner of his eye. He turns and it disappears.

ALEX

The killer. Oh shit, the killer! I'm dead...I'm dead!

He runs into the KITCHEN and pulls out a large KNIFE. A DOG'S YELP is heard

from another ROOM. He's nervously clutching the knife and goes to the front door—he goes outside.

ALEX

Queenie.....Queenie, here Queenie!

He goes back inside more afraid than ever. He walks around the LIVINGROOM looking every which way when the slightest NOISE is heard. A loud thump is heard at the front door. Close up of Alex's distraught face. He swallows hard and slowly paces to the front door.

ALEX

Oh God. Oh, God.

Alex grasps the knob and slowly turns it. He pulls the DOOR back which squeaks in its hinges. He looks out to the yard, then down. He sees his DOG with its throat cut lying at his feet. Loud THUNDER rumbles and a streak of lightning dances across the horizon.

He drops the KNIFE and bolts away running past the garage and up the HILL. Ben is just driving up in his beat up car and sees Alex running. Alex looks back and thinks he's being chased. He climbs the hill for his life. CAMERA from another angle, chasing Alex. Alex looks back and screams as Ben tackles him.

BEN

Hey! I told you to keep cool!

ALEX

(In hysterics) It's Queenie! He got Queenie!

BEN

It's alright, it's cool, be cool, stay cool, everything's cool. Now, what got Queenie?

ALEX

The killer, man! We've gotta get the fuck outta here!

Ben shakes his head and looks around as though Alex has completely lost it. He looks into the SKY.

BEN

Alex, man, you're trippin' too hard. I know something that'll relax you.

He pulls out a JOINT, lights it, takes a hit and passes it to Alex. He slaps it out of his hand.

ALEX

What? That's your solution to everything! You think I've lost it completely, don't you?

I'm trying to tell you he's killed my dog! You don't believe me! Queenie's down chopped up by the door. He POINTS in the direction of the house.

Ben picks up the joint and LIGHTS it again.

ALEX

What the fuck are you doing? How can you sit there and smoke at a time like this?

BEN

This is how people see me, this is what I got in trouble for; so I might as well enjoy myself while I'm fucked.

ALEX

What the HELL?

BEN

(Looks at Alex and extinguishes his JOINT) You're right, we shouldn't just sit here. Let's go down to your place and get something to drink. (He begins to walk down the hill.)

ALEX

Hey! Don't go down there! Are you crazy?

BEN

Me? Crazy? Taking two hits of double-dipped acid is crazy.....not to mention stupid. (He reaches the front door--it is halfway open. There is nothing to be seen, the dog carcass has vanished. Alex runs after him down the hill.) Where's this dead dog of yours? Hey, take a deep breath and.....GET YOUR UGLY ASS DOWN HERE!!!

Ben walks into the HOUSE and eyes the knife on the floor. He picks it up and sets it on

the counter in the KITCHEN. He goes to the REFRIGERATOR, looks around, pulls out a BEER and pops it. When he closes the DOOR, Alex is standing there looking off to the side. He has the KNIFE again in his hand. Ben is startled and jumps back.

BEN

Shit! Don't scare me like that! (Relaxes) Your mom didn't count these did she? Hello? Alex? (He waves his hand in front of Alex's stare) Are you there? Excuse me, (he walks around Alex) while I use the bathroom.

Alex goes to the LIVINGROOM and sits down on the couch with his back to the camera. It approaches Alex. A HAND reaches out and grabs Alex's shoulder.

BEN

Boo!

ALEX

Oh shit! (He whirls around, sees Ben and a DARK FIGURE directly behind him. The FIGURE raises an axe above its head) Oh, shit! Look out! Get down! Get outta the way! (Alex raises the KNIFE)

Ben looks confused then turns around and screams.

BEN

Oh, help me! There's nothing here! Save me from this terrible nothingness! (Laughs) I think maybe I should put on some music before you give yourself a coronary.

Ben goes to the STEREO and puts MUSIC on, then is about to go outside.

ALEX

Not funny man.....where are you going?

BEN

I'm going to get my bong, okay? If I'm not back by tomorrow, call the military.
(Follow Ben to his car)

Cut to:

INT. Steve-O's room. He is still eyeing his bookshelf and picks up the PHONE. He begins to dial then hangs up. CAMERA in on his face. The PENCIL is in his mouth and

he's studying the titles on the shelf. CAMERA back on the SHELF. Steve-O's HAND reaches and pulls out a small, browned, tattered BOOK. He sets it before him.

CAMERA looking over the shoulder of Steve-O as he opens the JOURNAL. He flips through it and a full SKETCH of the AMULET is seen. CAMERA in on Steve-O's face. CAMERA on the diary. Steve-O closes the JOURNAL and opens it again at the beginning. Small cursive writing fills the book and the date 5 MAY 1837, is SEEN.

Cut to:

Ben in his car digging under the SEAT.

BEN

Where in...ah, there you are.

Ben pulls out the BONG and kisses it. He walks back to Alex's house and to the KITCHEN. he fills the BONG up with WATER, packs the BOWL and takes a HIT.

BEN

Yeah! Ahhhh.....

He walks into the LIVINGROOM.

BEN

Alex!.....Yo! Man! Where did he run off to now? Hey! Why'd you turn off the music? (He goes to the STEREO and pushes PLAY. He goes upstairs to Alex's ROOM where he sees Alex crouched in the corner shaking with the KNIFE.) Dude, you're messed up. I'm telling you you'd better relax. Just listen to the music.

ALEX

And I'm tellin' you I didn't turn the music off.

BEN

Yeah, the music turned itself off. (He takes another hit from the BONG) Wow, this shit kicks your ass.

ALEX

Since when did you have a bong?

BEN

Since always.

The STEREO goes off. Alex's eyes dart back and forth. Ben blows smoke out. It is completely silent.

BEN

I'm sure there's a simple explanation.

ALEX

Yeah. If there is, I'd like to hear it right now. 'Cause there isn't. (Pause)

Listen.....he's coming up the stairs.

Alex stands against the wall with the KNIFE in hand. Ben takes another HIT.

BEN

Don't make me tie you down. In fact, why don't you put the knife down? I'm not so sure that with your frame of mind a knife is the best thing to have....why don't you let me take care of the knife, huh?

ALEX

Stay away from me! Stay the fuck away from me!

BEN

LISTEN TO ME! IT'S BEN! GIVE ME THE FUCKIN' KNIFE AND I MEAN IT! YOU'RE FUCKED UP RIGHT NOW! GET A GRIP! THE KNIFE! NOW! (Alex looks sad then hands the KNIFE to Ben) Damn straight. Now, I'll turn the music back on and we'll gel out together, okay?

CAMERA follows Ben as he goes to turn the music back on. He goes to the STEREO and pulls out the CD. He eyes it, letting it glint in the light, and places it back in the STEREO and pushes PLAY.

BEN

Let's see if that makes the difference.

He takes another HIT of weed and comes out of the LIVINGROOM. Alex is standing there as if he's seen a ghost.

BEN

Fuck! Cough! Cough! Cough! I told you not to sneak up on me like that. (Hack!)

Man, you don't look so good.

ALEX

I don't feel so good.

BEN

Well, sit down.

Ben guides Alex to the couch.

Cut to:

Steve-O reading from the JOURNAL about the history of the AMULET.

V.O.

On the second of May 1857. This journal was writ to fully tell the events of the evening of 6 July 1836 and to explore the fate of the amulet of Dagon.

Steve-O rubs his FOREHEAD and stares off at the BOOKSHELF. He rubs his eyes and goes back to READING.

V.O.

As for the amulet itself, after being broken into five pieces, the families of Carson, Killingworth, Uncler, Preston, and De la Poer took a separate piece and buried each on a hill far removed from the other so that no man could reunite the amulet as one.

Steve-O flips through the JOURNAL and sees a drawing of the AMULET. He snaps the PENCIL and reaches for the PHONE. (Pause) He picks up the PHONE and DIALS.

STEVE-O

Matt? Hey this is Steve. I just figured out what that pendant was around Alex's neck. Remember? The one I told you about. It's a goddamned necromancy amulet. Yeah. To Dagon. Yeah. Apparently the thing is supposed to work. We've got to get ahold of Alex before something happens. We've got to warn him, he could be in trouble.

Cut to:

Alex's house. Alex and Ben sitting on the couch.

ALEX

I can't stand this sitting around shit. We've gotta leave.

BEN

Why? (Ben makes a SILLY FACE. Alex notices.)

ALEX

'Cause we have to...and stop that!

BEN

What? (He contracts his FACE again)

ALEX

That! (Alex arches his back pulling himself away)

Ben continues.

ALEX

If you don't stop, I'm really gonna freak!

BEN

(Freezes his FACE and affects a FUNNY VOICE) Okay man, what ya' say?

ALEX

I say let's get the fuck outta here. It ain't a good idea to hang around.

BEN

And why is it not a good idea to stay here? (He smiles broadly) This has got to be one of the safest places on earth. You're on the top of a mountain, got clean air, squirrels, and.....(THUNDER rumbles the house, Alex looks panic stricken) besides.....I'm too stoned to drive anywhere.

ALEX

So? I can drive. (Gets wide-eyed)

BEN

Yeah, right.

ALEX

(Gets up and PACES the ROOM) Look, I'm okay, I've calmed down, I'm better.

BEN

Why don't you sit down—enjoy your trip.

ALEX

Can't sit man. Gotta go, gotta go now.

BEN

Hey, my promise to tie you down still holds.

ALEX

C'mon Ben, I can drive.

BEN

Yeah, right. Besides, (checks his POCKETS) I don't have my keys anyway.

ALEX

(Looks worried) Where are they?

BEN

(Smiles) Must be in the car, dude.

Alex turns and darts out the DOOR to Ben's car. Ben sighs loudly and chases out after him. By the time he gets to his car, Alex is already behind the wheel with the keys in the ignition. The WIND has started to blow and heavy clouds are shadowing the sun.

Cut to:

Steve-O's ROOM. He is still on the PHONE with Matt.

STEVE-O

Yeah. I just need to tell him we're coming up. If you want to bring her along.....I guess that's fine with me. Yeah. I'll do that. Bye.

Steve-O presses the hang-up BUTTON then re-dials Alex's number. The ringing is heard through the PHONE.

Cut to:

EXT. Alex's house. Ben is climbing into the CAR as the ringing of the PHONE is heard in the distance. Ben stares at Alex.

ALEX

What? See, I'm fine, got lots of feeling everywhere. (Shakes his hands)

BEN

You're so goddamned silly. You sure you're alright?

ALEX

Yeah. (Long pause) Trust me.

Cut to:

EXT. Ben's car—FRONT. Alex starts Ben's car up. Shifts into neutral by mistake and REVVS the engine high.

Cut to:

INT. Ben's car.

ALEX

Sorry. It looks all the same from here.

BEN

Yeah. (Lies back in his seat and gazes up at the ceiling)

Cut to:

Down the DRIVEWAY, CAMERA pointed at the car. Alex shifts and takes off. He picks up speed.

Cut to:

INT. Car.

ALEX

(Looks at Ben) See, I'm just fine. (Ben appears as if he's passed out)

ALEX

Just can't take it can ya', dude.

Alex turns to look back at the ROAD and a CURVE is close ahead. He freezes.

Cut to:

EXT. Car misses the CURVE and smashes into a TREE. Both Alex and Ben hit the windshield. (Long pause, CAMERA drawn into car. Flashes of silent LIGHTNING.)

1st person camera view: CAMERA view is smeary and twisted. Alex (camera) looks over at Ben, he is still with some light streams of blood running down his cheek. An ARM comes out of frame and shakes Ben who does not respond. The HAND shakes him more vigorously—no reaction.

ALEX (V.O.)

(Slow, twisted voice) Ben.....Ben.....Oh, Shit.....

3rd person camera view: Alex gets out of the CAR. He's woozy, stumbles. He wanders across the road into the WOODS.

1st person camera view: CAMERA takes over Alex's point of view. LEAVES crunching (sounds are muted) as the footsteps are taken. (MUSIC OVER: Intro to "In the Light" by Led Zeppelin.)

Aimless wandering into the trees, heavy breathing and the pace quickens. A singular DARK FIGURE is seen out of the corner of sight. CAMERA stops and pans towards the direction of the sighting—nothing. A brilliant flash of LIGHTNING blinds the landscape.

Moving again. Heavier breathing. Alex starts to panic. CAMERA sees a CLEARING, CAMERAMAN trips over some logs and falls face down. Moans and the CAMERA is shaken. Alex looks up and a DARK FIGURE is clearly seen standing by a TREE. Alex screams and shields his eyes.

Covering his eyes (CAMERA) with his forearm, he gets up and runs. Struck by BRANCHES as he runs quickly past them. He turns back to look behind him several times. He runs into the CLEARING he was just in earlier.

3rd person camera view: Shot of Alex looking at the TREES straight ahead of him. Close-up of his eyes—they widen. Pull back. His jaw drops. He mouths quietly, CAMERA pulls back fast, spins 180 degrees and it's 1st person view again.

1st person camera view: CAMERA quick shifting like slides in a projector. A DARK FIGURE beside a TREE, then the FIGURE is gone, then it's back and gone again. CAMERA gradually spins until it (Alex) is shoved from behind. Then a collapse and BLACKOUT.

3rd person camera view: In the BLACKNESS, sobbing is heard—shaking quivering sobbing coupled with a distant CHANTING. Open, looking at LEAVES, pan back and we see Alex lying on his back. The AMULET about his neck has a glow to it. He sits up and wipes his FACE with his SHIRT.

Alex gets up and looks around him. The CHANTING has faded and he sees a HOUSE. He staggers to it and goes through the ajar front DOOR. He goes inside—quiet. He wanders silently into a dimly-lit BEDROOM where he sees two people sleeping. Alex is standing in the DOORWAY. A slight CHANTING is heard in the distance.

A DARK FIGURE comes in through another DOORWAY dangling a PENDANT on a chain between his fingers. The FIGURE stops and we SEE the PENDANT reflecting the dim light. It is another piece of the AMULET. The FIGURE mumbles a CHANT similar to the one being spoken in the distance. He wraps his hand with the chain bearing between his fingers the sharp edge of the AMULET.

The DARK FIGURE kisses the AMULET and stabs it into one of the sleeping people. She screams. The man next to her wakes up and attacks the FIGURE. The FIGURE jumps on the man and cuts his throat with the AMULET piece.

As the man lies still, the FIGURE gets up and stands beside the bed.

FIGURE

Bathed in blood, cleansed in blood. My ancestry is pleased.

The FIGURE unwraps the chain and places the AMULET piece in a small bag. The FIGURE walks right by Alex as if he doesn't see him. The FIGURE sits on the blood-soaked bed and pulls out three other small bags. He opens a drawer by the NIGHTSTAND, dumps out the contents and places it bottom up on his lap.

He dumps the four AMULET fragments onto the drawer. The FIGURE laughs as he sets the pieces into their original patterns.

FIGURE

Please let this be enough, work as one without the fifth piece.

Close up of the FIGURE'S HANDS moving the FOUR pieces together. As the pieces get closer, a noise rumbles through the HOUSE. The pieces are almost together. But as they almost touch, a vivid shock of ELECTRICITY hits the FIGURE'S HANDS. He reels back and the pieces move apart.

FIGURE

The fifth piece. It won't work without it. (Pause)

CAMERA from Alex's point of view looking at the FIGURE seated on the bed.

FIGURE

The fifth part as to make a whole. I need it to avenge my lineage, but where is it?
(FIGURE slowly turns and looks at Alex. The FIGURE is Tom.) Well, hello Alex. I
know just where to find it.

CAMERA on Alex as the AMULET piece is glowing on his chest. Tom gets up and walks towards Alex.

TOM

The two families meet on one side, one on the other. Which one is better hmm, Alex?

ALEX

(SWALLOWS hard and looks around) Tom.....Tom..... how could
you.....?

TOM

No time.

Tom shoves Alex down and grabs for the AMULET. Alex holds it tight in his grip. Tom is hovering over Alex.

TOM

If not now, then later. It's not over. There are still a lot of things to see. I promise you.

Alex turns and rolls on the floor.

Cut to:

3rd person camera view: We SEE Alex rolling around in the LEAVES. He stops and gazes up at the TREES. He quickly gets up and walks. Pan around. We see a HOUSE in the distance. Alex walks towards it.

Cut to:

CAMERA just outside the front door of Alex's HOUSE. A FIGURE is seen entering the HOUSE.

Alex shuts the DOOR. (Facing inward, back against the door.) He takes a deep breath and CREAKING upstairs is heard. He walks to the foot of the STAIRS and afraid, looks up. Looking away, he eyes the KNIFE on the COFFEETABLE by the COUCH. He takes it and stalks upstairs.

Cut to:

Ben's car smashed against the TREE. Ben becomes conscious. He shakes his head and climbs out. He's a little more together than Alex was. He manages to stand, looks up and down the ROAD and walks up the ROAD to Alex's HOUSE.

Cut to:

Alex upstairs stalking each of the ROOMS hearing the CREAKING (footsteps) nearer and nearer.

Cut to:

Ben getting to the entrance of Alex's HOUSE.

Cut to:

Alex nearing the BATHROOM where the CREAKING seems to be emanating.

Cut to:

Ben opening the front DOOR. He slowly and quietly walks in and sits down on the COUCH.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: CAMERA comes out of the BATHROOM, the CREAKING has stopped upon exit. CAMERA paces down the HALL looking into each ROOM as it passes them. MUSIC is turned on downstairs.

CAMERA moves to the top of the STAIRS, swishes to the BODROOM then descends the STAIRS. CAMERA paces down the STAIRS, turns and we SEE Ben sitting on the COUCH with his back to the CAMERA. A KNIFE is seen in the HAND of the CAMERAMAN. CAMERA moves closer to Ben. Suddenly, Ben gets up and goes to the KITCHEN.

CAMERA follows Ben. As he bends and peers into the REFRIGERATOR, the CAMERA moves in close to the FRIDGE DOOR. As it is CLOSED, Ben, with BEER in hand, stares wide-eyed into the CAMERA.

BEN

Holy shit! Don't scare me like that.

3rd person camera view: It's Alex.

BEN

And put that damn knife down. (Pause) I'm gonna kill you.

ALEX

Ben, man, you won't believe.

Ben walks past Alex and sits back down on the COUCH. Alex follows him.

ALEX

Ben, you.....

BEN

(Takes a large gulp of BEER) Don't fuck with me now, you totaled my car.

ALEX

(Looking around) My God, they're dead.

BEN

(Rubs his FOREHEAD, smearing the blood) What? Who's dead? (He looks at the blood on his FINGERS)

ALEX

(Looks strained) Dead. All dead. (Ben smirking at the blood on his HAND and

rubbing his FOREHEAD harder) And I know who killed them, you know Ben, I saw him.....

BEN

How bad am I bleeding?

ALEX

I know, I know. He killed.....

BEN

Yeah, how bad.

ALEX

Ben.....

BEN

Aw, fuck it, I got to clean....(Ben gets up)

ALEX

Did you hear me? They're dead.

BEN

Yeah.

Ben goes to the KITCHEN and washes his face in the SINK. Alex FOLLOWS him.

ALEX

We can't stay here.

BEN

(Turns around and FACES Alex.) Did I get it all?

ALEX

Ben, he's here, I saw him, he could be here at any time.

BEN

I can't go. I feel like shit.

ALEX

It's Tom.

BEN

(Drying his FACE with the KITCHEN towel) What about him?

ALEX

He's the killer. (CREAKING is heard upstairs) Let's go.....

BEN

Shhhh.

ALEX

I swear, I wasn't trippin', I SAW him.

THUNDER rumbles the HOUSE and LIGHTNING shines through the curtained windows. Alex hurriedly looks around.

ALEX

I think we should get out of here.

BEN

(Whispering pacing to the stairs. CREAKING begins again.) How can we? It's who know how far to town. And you trashed my car. I should never have let you talk me into you driving.

ALEX

(Gets wide-eyed) Mr. Gilman's place, he has a car.

A loud CREAK is heard upstairs; footsteps follow. Ben looks scared.

BEN

What the fuck is that? Let's get the hell out of here.

Cut to:

POLICE STATION. Mike Dannon is staring at the county MAP on the wall. PINS mark the areas where the KILLER has struck.

MIKE

What the hell is the pattern? Somebody do their job and tell me.

OFFICER

No one's come up with anything sir.

MIKE

There's something, I can't place my finger on it, but I know we're not looking in exactly the right place. We can't think three-dimensionally. There is something.....

OFFICER

Sir?

MIKE

I know. It's almost ready to manifest itself. (THUNDER rumbles in the distance.)

Cut to:

On the ROAD away from Alex's HOUSE. THUNDER echoes from before. We SEE Ben and Alex walking down the ROAD. They pass Ben's car smashed against the tree.

BEN

My car.....it's totaled.

ALEX

It really doesn't look that bad.

Ben GLARES hard at Alex.

ALEX

Uh, maybe you're right.

They continue walking and we see Gilman's HOUSE. They walk up to the front DOOR. They ring the BELL and knock on the DOOR.

BEN

Looks like no one's home.

ALEX

He has to be. Crazy guy never leaves his house. He's too paranoid. (Ben walks to the DRIVEWAY)

BEN

Well, his car's here.

Alex meets Ben and they pace to Gilman's CAR. Alex notices the side door to the HOUSE is ajar. Alex POINTS to the open DOOR and they walk in.

ALEX

Mr. Gilman! Mr. Gilman! You home! Hey! Yo!

They walk into the LIVINGROOM.

ALEX

Wonder where he is, it's only two he should be home.

BEN

Maybe he wanted some exercise and went out for a walk.

ALEX

He can't walk, he's in a wheelchair.

BEN

Maybe he went out for a roll.

They continue walking around and reach a flight of STAIRS. Alex begins to form a SMILE. He turns to Ben and laughs.

BEN

What's so funny?

ALEX

Out for a roll, man, that's not funny. (Calms himself and looks UPSTAIRS) Go upstairs and check. I'll look in the kitchen.

Ben nods and slowly ascends the stairs.

BEN

(To himself) Are you home? Are you here?

CAMERA behind Ben following as he goes UPSTAIRS. Ben slows, turns and looks behind him. He continues walking up looking behind him.

Cut to:

Alex sneaking around the KITCHEN looking around. The KITCHEN is in a bizarre state of disarray, things are spilled out on the COUNTERS and the FLOOR. Alex lifts a CAN and looks under it.

ALEX

Mr. Gilman, you here?

Alex sees a small flight of STAIRS and ascends it. He sees doors down the HALL, it is perfectly quiet. He goes in one of the DOORS near to the end of the HALL and closes it behind him.

Cut to:

As the DOOR closes Ben comes into view at the other end of the HALL walking towards the CAMERA. Ben is starting to shake. CAMERA moves in close. FOOTSTEPS are heard downstairs. (CREAKING) He jumps a little.

BEN

(Whispers) Gotta be Alex...Alex. (Loudly) Alex! (Whispers) God, I hope so.

Ben turns to walk down the HALL. He is visibly anxious. Suddenly, a DOOR directly beside him is thrown open and it almost hits him.

ALEX

Yo! What!

BEN

(Incredibly startled) Shit! Holy shit!!!

Ben reels back to the top of the STAIRS. He hangs precariously on the edge of one STAIR. Alex runs to help but instead of grabbing him, he ends up SHOVING him.

ALEX

Ben! Watch out!

Ben TUMBLES down the STAIRS. Alex scrambles down and hovers over him.

ALEX

Ben, are you okay? Speak to me, man!!! Speak to me!!!! Ben!!!!

BEN

Oh. Umph.

ALEX

Ben, don't die on me!

BEN

Ow, my leg. (Ben grabs his ANKLE and winces)

ALEX

(Puts his hand on the back of his head) Okay, what to do. I guess Mr. Gilman's not here, we gotta keep moving. He'll get us. Oh, that's right, Ben, I didn't tell you.....

BEN

Keep moving? Can't stay? (Almost crying)

ALEX

He could be anywhere.

BEN

Ow! My ankle, it's gotta be broken.

ALEX

No, it can't be. (Kneels)

BEN

Why not?

ALEX

Let me see. (Grabs Ben's ANKLE)

BEN

Ow! Ow! Be careful.

ALEX

I don't think it's broken.

BEN

Yes it is, I should know. It's my leg.

ALEX

If you can move it, it's not broken.

BEN

I can't. I can't!

ALEX

Yes you can. (He twists his ANKLE)

Cut to:

CAMERA outside Gilman's looking at the HOUSE. Ben's pain-filled scream is heard.

Cut to:

Back inside the HOUSE.

ALEX

See, man, the doc says it's not broken.

BEN

(In tears, mumbling inaudibly) If I get bett.....I'm gonna....you...

ALEX

What was that? Hey, I've got a great idea.

BEN

No.....no.....no more ideas!

ALEX

My father taught me how to make a brace if someone's ankle is broken. I'll be right back.

BEN

I told you.....I told you.....

Alex darts through the HOUSE to the GARAGE.

ALEX

Okay, how does one make.....there.

He grabs two misshaped pieces of WOOD, then a length of ROPE from the wall. As he walks back out of the GARAGE, he swoons, places his hand over his eyes, dropping the WOOD and the ROPE.

1st person camera view: CAMERA moves through the WOODS, it is near dark since the FOREST is so dense—it blots out almost all the light of the day. CAMERA fights its way through to a CLEARING (TWILIGHT).

We SEE the 1st VILLIAGER, he looks similar to Alex. He is his ancestor. He looks at the CAMERA.

1st VILLIAGER

There is a time when the myths of the past have links to the present and to you.

3rd person camera view: We SEE Alex and 1st Villager standing just apart.

ALEX

Who are you?

1st VILLIAGER

I am Francis you're great, great....let's just say grandfather. I want to show you something.

Alex and Francis walk through the FOREST to a small rotted, unkempt cemetery.

FRANCIS

And these are my family and friends, they are here because of Dagon.

Alex shakes his head and mumbles to himself.

FRANCIS

You see Alex, Dagon killed these people, stole the very life out of them. It is because of the amulet. (Points to the AMULET around Alex's neck. Alex looks down at it.) Dagon at first was for the crops, when all of us first came to this valley and we needed protection for survival. Jonathon Beledire brought the amulet from England, it protected us. But they started experimenting with the powers of the amulet and they became obsessed.

Our town was divided, those with Beledire and those against him, our family was always against him. We fought their cult and tried to bring its downfall—nothing worked and we were soon overcome by its powers.

Beledire got curious, he wanted to know what was after death, what things were like. He figured if brought back, the dead could tell of the great journeys it had completed offering secrets to the other realms. And it worked. They brought back the dead, but at great expense. With each newly raised dead, a life had to be exchanged, usually one of the townspeople were targeted. Beledire wanted to know.

In 1836, we finally got enough courage to fight. Whoever was left and still with us, we gathered weapons, killed Beledire and Dagon or so we thought.

The amulet was divided into five pieces and scattered among the hills surrounding the valley, we never wanted the amulet assembled—Dagon could not live again at any cost.

Through the years our families have kept an eye out for Beledires. A descendant escaped our raid and we could never locate him directly. In 1879, we found his child, Arthur Beledire and his wife. They were killed. In 1911, we found Henry Beledire, he was killed. We tracked and tracked them, one always seems to elude us. Finally, we thought we had no worries. In 1961, we discovered quite by accident, Roger Beledire, his wife Mary and their child Thomas. Roger and Mary were killed by your father, it was made to look like an automobile accident.

We searched their house and to our surprise, we found a piece of the Dagon amulet. It was confiscated and George took care of it. Now you have it.

THUNDER rumbles in the distance and LIGHTNING dances across the sky. The TOMBSTONES behind Francis begin to stir. Alex stares at them.

FRANCIS

Do not be afraid, my son, they are merely anxious. Alex, listen to me. You must be very careful not to let that amulet get into the hands of Thomas Beledire, he somehow has gathered the other four and has set his sights upon the fifth.

ALEX

Why don't you just have him killed like the others?

FRANCIS

It's not that simple. Each Beledire was killed by a man who wanted to kill. He knew of his duties to the good of the world and performed his task accordingly. Thomas is the last Beledire, we know, he must not put the amulet together.

THUNDER rumbles harder in the distance. The WIND picks up and blows the WEEDS in the cemetery.

FRANCIS

Keep the memory of them alive. (Points to the TOMBSTONES) They died horribly and it's up to you not to let it happen to others.

Francis turns to walk to the cemetery. Alex holds the AMULET in his hand and looks at Francis. He calls out to him.

ALEX

My father what happened to my father? Why did he die?

The WIND blows harder and LIGHTNING flashes vibrantly. Francis turns and faces Alex.

FRANCIS

No time.

CAMERA pulls back from Alex standing in the cemetery. Loud claps of THUNDER are heard—a great flash of LIGHTNING blinds the CAMERA.

Cut to:

CAMERA looking out the window of Gilman's GARAGE. A flash of LIGHTNING has just blinded Alex as he stood staring outside.

3rd person camera view: Alex rubs his eyes and looks about the GARAGE. He is SHAKING from fear.

ALEX

You're trippin' Alex, that's all. Bad trip. That shit WAS double dipped you know. (He shakes himself off and tries to SMILE) Nothin' else, just a bad trip. (He looks around the GARAGE and see the WOOD and the ROPE)

Oh shit.....Ben.

He scrambles for the WOOD and ROPE and rushes back to Ben.

ALEX

Sorry, man.

BEN

What the hell happened to you??!!

ALEX

I was trippin', and you wouldn't believe....

BEN

(Covers his ears) I don't wanna hear it.

ALEX

Alright. Okay. (He sets the WOOD and ROPE down. He looks at Ben's leg.) How does it feel?

BEN

Horrible.

ALEX

Don't worry, I'm going to fix you up right.

BEN

Please, be careful. On second thought, forget it, don't bother.

ALEX

(Kneels by Ben's ANKLE) No, I got you messed up like this and I'm going to make it better.

BEN

No, ah, you'll only make it worse!

ALEX

Hey, have faith in me.

Alex straightens Ben's LEG out and sets the ill-length pieces of WOOD beside it.

ALEX

Well, they're a little off but.....

He pulls the WOOD in tight and starts at Ben's foot to wrap the SPLINT with the ROPE.

ALEX

Could you lift your leg a bit?

BEN

No, it hurts too.....

Alex smirks, lifts Ben's LEG and sets it on his KNEE. Ben moans. He continues to wrap with the ROPE.

ALEX

Shit, how much rope is there here?

BEN

Why don't you just cut some of it off?

ALEX

Almost done.

He finishes and proudly looks at what he's done. The SPLINT bears a striking resemblance to a cast.

ALEX

My father taught me this on our camping trips.

BEN

(Sees what Alex has accomplished) What have you done to my leg??!!

ALEX

C'mon, stand up, let's see how it works.

BEN

I'm sure not too well.

Alex helps Ben to his feet. The mismatched pieces of WOOD almost reach to Ben's crotch.

ALEX

I suppose I could've put the shorter piece of the inside.

BEN

Put the shorter piece on the inside?! That's all you can say?! You nearly killed me and all you can say is 'I should've put the shorter piece on the inside?!'

ALEX

It's the best I could do on such short notice.

BEN

Great Alex, fuckin' great.

ALEX

Let's try it out.

Alex grabs Ben and pulls him into the LIVINGROOM. Ben tries to walk but the WOOD hits him square in the balls. He yelps.

ALEX

Don't be such a baby, give it another try.

Ben tries to walk but doesn't have much luck. He ends up dragging his LEG.

BEN

Yeah, Alex, works fine, just fine. Did your dad teach you any other useless things such as this?

ALEX

Not really.

BEN

Guess not. (Ben looks at Alex who is sad. Ben loosens up and staggers out the side DOOR—Alex follows.)

Well, Einstein, got any brilliant ideas how to get us out of here?

ALEX

Um, my plan 'B' was that we could walk to the main road and flag down somebody
but.....(eyes Ben's LEG)

BEN

Yeah, thanks a lot.

Alex paces around outside, scratches the back of his head and looks at Gilman's CAR.

ALEX

Well, we could borrow Mr. Gilman's car.....

BEN

Shhhhh.

ALEX

What?

BEN

Listen.

The sound of a running electric MOTOR is heard.

ALEX

What? That bubbling? God Ben, it sounds like a hot tub.

BEN

Yeah, but it just started. Maybe it's on a timer.

ALEX

(Looking panic stricken) Maybe ol' Gilman's home after all. (Alex starts walking to
the BACKYARD, Ben grabs his arm.)

BEN

I hope it's him.

Alex swallows hard. They slowly pace to the back FENCE. Alex peers over the GATE
then opens it and looks around the BACKYARD.

ALEX

All clear.

They walk into the BACKYARD and see the HOT TUB over in the far corner. It is covered. The sound of the electric MOTOR is emanating from it.

Cut to:

Steve-O, Matt, and Cindy driving up Spring Mountain road on the way to Alex's HOUSE. Steve-O is driving; Matt and Cindy are making out in the BACKSEAT.

STEVE-O

I hope he's home, I've got a lot to tell him. (Looks in his REARVIEW MIRROR and sees them kissing) Do you think he's there, Matt?

No response. Steve-O looks upset.

STEVE-O

If you two would stop it, it would make driving just a little bit easier.

No response. Steve-O shakes his head and sighs loudly. He looks out the WINDOW and whispers quietly to himself.

STEVE-O

I hope you're okay Alex.

Cut to:

Alex and Ben in Gilman's BACKYARD. The CAMERA is poised over the FENCE behind the HOT TUB pointed at Alex and Ben's progress across the BACKYARD. They stop a couple of times, look at each other and swallow hard.

Cut to:

Alex and Ben standing on the brick walkway that surrounds the HOT TUB.

ALEX

Doesn't make much sense running a hot tub with the cover on. Maybe it's on a timer, like you said...

Ben eyes the cover and sees an unusual BULGE beneath it. He points and Alex sees it

as well. Both stare wide-eyed.

ALEX

What do you think we should do?

BEN

(Long pause) I don't know.

ALEX

Go see what it is.

BEN

What?! No way. You check.

Alex squats, reaches out his HAND and grabs the edge of the HOT TUB COVER. He quickly lets go and reels back. Ben is startled.

BEN

What's the matter?

ALEX

What if it IS Gilman?

BEN

We've got to know.

ALEX

Okay, okay. Clear the senses. (He takes a deep breath)

Alex moves, kneels, and grabs the COVER with both HANDS.

ALEX

Ready?

BEN

(Sighs and wipes his MOUTH with his wrist) Yeah.

Alex yanks the cover back. Gilman's lifeless body is floating in the frothing HOT TUB. Water, stained with blood, is on Alex's HANDS. He gasps at the sight of Gilman's

body.

ALEX

Uh, uh, uh.....

BEN (O.S.)

Oh my fucking God!!!!!!.....

ALEX

Let's get the fuck outta here!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

Alex runs by Ben, who's mesmerized by what he's seeing, and yanks on his ARM. Alex drags Ben back to the side of the HOUSE. They lean up against the SIDING.

ALEX

I.....I.....can't believe.....what does HE have to do with any of this?

Breathing heavily, Ben looks up at the cloudy SKY. THUNDER rumbles loudly.

BEN

What? You were right, (pause) you were right man. There IS a killer. I should've listened to you.....

ALEX

What the hell are we gonna do? You know, it's this that's causing all this.

BEN

(Runs his fingers thorough his knotted hair) Don't know...but we've got to get outta here.

ALEX

I know, I know, don't you think I know that?

Alex looks and sees Gilman's CAR.

ALEX

I got an idea.

He walks to Gilman's CAR and puts his HANDS on the HOOD.

ALEX

I'm a hot-wire specialist.

BEN

Are you sure about that?

CAMERA sees Ben's point of view looking out the WINDSHIELD. The HOOD raises. Alex is heard yanking at things.

ALEX

Shit! Damn thing!

BEN

Maybe he has a set of keys in the house.

Alex turns and leans against the FENCE with his HAND. Ben climbs out of the CAR and stands next to Alex. Silence. They are staring at the ground motionless. Alex suddenly bursts out to break the silence.

ALEX

What the fuck are we gonna do? We're gonna die, I know it! (He starts pacing quickly)

Shit, shit.....I'm getting the fuck outta here!

BEN

Keys, Alex.

Alex darts off into the thick WOODS that surrounds the HOUSE. Ben yells at his back and he tries to follow—he's dragging his braced LEG. He turns to look at Gilman's HOUSE. He sees a dark figure leaning out an upstairs WINDOW. Ben stops and stares at the figure who then laughs.

BEN

Tom?

TOM

Hey! Hold up there!

Tom moves quickly away from the WINDOW.

BEN

What the hell.....?

Ben turns and runs into the WOODS after Alex.

Cut to:

POLICE STATION. Mike Dannon is still surveying the wall MAP. He runs his finger around the areas of the killings. He turns his back on the MAP and picks up a CUP of coffee on his desk. As he brings the CUP to his lips, his EYES widen. He whirls around and faces the MAP again.

MIKE

Daily! Get me a topographical map of the county!

Cut to:

The WOODS. Ben is limping along dragging his LEG. He sees Alex ahead leaning against a TREE.

BEN

What the fuck? Why'd you leave me back there? Tom is chasing after us.

ALEX

I told you and you wouldn't believe me. It was Tom, he wants the amulet.

BEN

What? Huh? Yeah.....

ALEX

The amulet! (He holds out the piece around his NECK) He wants this!

BEN

Why?

ALEX

It's a long story.

BEN

I think we should keep moving.

ALEX

(WHISPERING) Shut up. I hear him.

In the distance, LEAVES are heard crunching underfoot. Ben turns to look in the direction of the NOISE. Alex runs off not waiting for Ben. When he looks back, Alex is gone.

BEN

Not again!

Ben fiddles with the SPLINT on his LEG. He chases after Alex in the direction he thinks he went. He drags his braced LEG behind him. CAMERA follows Ben as he moves through the FOREST. CAMERA begins behind Ben then shoots past him and rounds his front. Ben stops occasionally to listen and look around—nothing. He is visibly tired and his sweat has mixed with the dried blood in his hair, causing light streams to run down his FACE. He stops and sees a little hidden SHELTER of LOGS. He goes to the SHELTER, sits down, and lies back against some LOGS.

Cut to:

Alex running through the TREES.

1st person camera view:

ALEX (V.O.)

No way.....no way he's gonna get me.

CAMERA races through the TREES as Alex's perspective.

Cut to:

POLICE STATION. Mike looking at the topographical MAP laid out on his desk. Several OFFICERS look on.

MIKE

If we set this map over the other one we get this.

Mike lays one MAP over the other. Two OFFICERS hold the MAP onto the WALL.

MIKE

Okay, he's hit here, here, here, and here, right? (He points.) It looks like.....my God...(he faces Daily) he's hitting the mountains, the tops of the goddamned mountains!

DAILY

(Walks to the MAP and peers at it closely) Mike, according to that theory, he hasn't hit every mountain.

MIKE

(Looks at Daily) Yeah....

DAILY

Everyone except for Windsor's Peak. (POINTS)

MIKE

That's where the Preston family lives.

Mike pauses and stares off. Daily looks perplexedly at him.

MIKE

My, son's friend, Alex, lives on that mountain (long pause) and...(yells) Get every available man and get to Windsor's Peak as fast as you can! Move!

The OFFICERS scatter and Mike reaches for the PHONE on his DESK. He DIALS and listens.

MIKE

Ben, you'd better be home.....(the line RINGS and RINGS) Dammit!

Mike slams the receiver down on the PHONE and rushes out.

Cut to:

CAMERA fixed on the roadway just below Alex's HOUSE. A CAR is seen moving up the hill. As it passes the CAMERA, we SEE it is Steve-O, Matt, and Cindy.

CAMERA on TREES on opposite side of the road. A NOISE comes from them. CAMERA pulls into the TREES.

Cut to:

3rd person camera view: Alex running through the FOREST. He looks behind him and

sees a FIGURE chasing him. He is fear stricken and the DRUGS he took earlier has now engulfed him. He looks a second time, he sees nothing but as he looks where he's going, he hits a patch of TWIGS, falls through them and tumbles into a pile of LEAVES in the center of this PATCH. He hears NOISES outside of this circle of twigs. NOISES as if someone is pacing around the outside of the PATCH. THUNDER roars and leaves rain down about Alex. He sits up quickly and looks around him.

1st person camera view: CAMERA quick shifting like slides in a projector—of trunks of gnarled TREES, twisted patches of rotted TWIGS, and cyclones of decayed LEAVES. The LEAVES are still raining down.

3rd person camera view: Alex kneeling, LEAVES stop. NOISES still happening. Alex crawls as quiet as he can to the opposite side the NOISES are occurring. He finds a small OPENING and proceeds to crawl through. He gets to the outside and runs again.

Chase scene through the WOODS. CAMERA behind Alex as he runs through various parts of the FOREST.

Cut to:

Ben against the LOGS. He removes the SPLINT. A loud crackling NOISE startles him. He peers just over the pile of LOGS, more NOISE. He starts to panic, gets up, and moves away. Ben wandering LIMPING through the WOODS.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: Alex (CAMERA running through the WOODS. The area becomes progressively darker/thicker—a GOTHIC feeling is depicted.

3rd person camera view: CAMERA fixed, Alex running toward it. He stops, only his EYES and FOREHEAD are SEEN. His EYES are wide and fear-struck.

1st person camera view: Mr. Gilman is standing in front of Alex (CAMERA) looking at him. He is drenched with WATER and his CLOTHES are stained with BLOOD. Francis Preston is standing next to him.

FRANCIS

Beledire is responsible for this. Remember, no matter what you think or what happens,
get to the De la Poer mansion.

Mr. Gilman SMILES.

MR. GILMAN

(Points at the AMULET around Alex's NECK) Keep a hold of that Alex, it's our only hope.

ALEX

Wha....?

FRANCIS

You will face a series of tests Alex, keep a fierce reign on your emotions and do not let go of the amulet.

3rd person camera view: Alex takes a quick GLANCE at Gilman and Francis and RUNS off. His HEART is beating furiously, his BREATH is short and quick. He is MUMBLING incoherent phrases.

Cut to:

Ben is quickening his pace and looking more and more often behind him. He appears to have stopped LIMPING. The sound of the crunching LEAVES behind him alerts the presence of a FOLLOWER. From his lack of observance, he trips and falls into a small RAVINE.

Cut to:

Alex running. Darting in and out of TREES. He reaches another CLEARING. CAMERA pans quickly back as the CHURCH from the OPENING SCENE, now in charred ruin, is SEEN.

ALEX

Oh, shit.

He grabs at the piece of AMULET around his neck. He walks to the CHURCH and peers in the bare WINDOWS. (Short flashes of scenes from the beginning are SEEN. The priest lifting the AMULET, the DEAD sitting up with the AMULET embedded in their chest, then a flash of Francis setting the place ablaze—and then the screams.)

Alex snaps out of it and lets go of the crystal. He shields his EARS with his HANDS and lets out a shrilling scream.

LIGHTNING dances across the sky coupled with a THUNDERCLAP.

FRANCIS (V.O.)

The amulet, Alex, the power in the amulet.

Alex looks around and wipes his MOUTH. He suddenly realizes something. He lifts the crystal to his FACE, it has a slight abnormal glow.

ALEX

(Peering into the AMULET) As old as time itself.

A flash of Francis hiking up to a MANSION is SEEN. Alex smiles, turns and runs back into the FOREST.

Cut to:

Alex's HOUSE. Steve-O, Matt, and Cindy pull up in the DRIVEWAY. The CAR is shut off and Steve-O gets out. He walks away from the CAR and realizes Matt and Cindy haven't. He walks back to the CAR.

STEVE-O

Will you two stop it.

Matt and Cindy break apart. She pulls up her top and yanks on her shorts. Matt grabs at her breast.

Cindy

Quit it!

STEVE-O

We're here to see Alex. He's got to know what's going on before it's too late. Let's go!

Steve-O walks toward the HOUSE, Matt and Cindy, wrapped around each other, follow. Steve-O notices the front DOOR is ajar.

STEVE-O

I hope to God we're not too late.

The three of them go INSIDE. Steve-O is intent on finding out what's going on, he doesn't pay attention to Matt or Cindy. They end up wandering off UPSTAIRS. Steve-

O goes into the LIVINGROOM and looks around.

As he is passing the library, he sees a small JOURNAL resting on the DESK. He has a seat and examines it. CREAKING is heard UPSTAIRS.

Cindy

(From UPSTAIRS, in a playful VOICE) Stop it, keep away.

MATT

Aw honey, please.

Steve-O shakes his head and sighs loudly. He goes back to the JOURNAL.

Cut to:

CAMERA outside the HOUSE looking at various parts of it. CAMERA moves to the back PORCH, then to the side where a pile of cut LOGS and an AXE are. Focus on the AXE. CAMERA moves away and looks at the HOUSE again, the WIND is blowing fiercely and it is becoming dark.

CAMERA moves to the patio TABLE, to a GATE and goes over it. It goes in the side DOOR and moves through the HOUSE. It rounds a corner and faces the BATHROOM, the STEREO, then the STAIRS.

STEVE-O (O.S.)

‘I remember the time when I had to kill because of my ancestry...’

The CAMERA goes into the living area to the DESK where Steve-O is sitting. It comes to rest looking at the JOURNAL over Steve-O’s shoulder.

STEVE-O

Thomas Beledire? Alex’s stepfather?

Steve-O continues reading from the JOURNAL.

STEVE-O

‘All that matters is getting the amulet put together, there is no other obstacle. Imagine the family reprieve, the slander on the Beledire name, had I not carried out the tasks designed by my ancestry. As far as I know I am the last Beledire and awaiting discovery at any time by the others.’

Steve-O sets the JOURNAL down and stares off. The WIND is howling outside. He rubs his FOREHEAD, flips through the JOURNAL and goes back to reading from it.

STEVE-O

‘The murders were quite easy after having located the families protecting the pieces of the amulet. A knife in the throat, a shot to the head, crushing the skull under the force of a bat. I found after the third murder that I actually started to enjoy my work but that’s when the police caught on and the serial killer headlines started to stain the local papers.

I had to be more careful. Although the needs for being more careful were evident, I still would erase anybody who ‘interfered’ with my tasks. (Pause)

‘Now, after nearly three weeks of searching, I’ve located the fifth and final piece of Dagon. You should have heard my elation in discovering it was right under my nose all the time. How fate would have it my new wife’s son would possess the amulet! But

I’ve got to be careful, can’t make the killing too obvious, could lead the tide of suspicion my way. No, this one is going to take a while but I know an opportunity will present itself vibrantly, and when it does, I’ll be there.’

Steve-O pulls himself away from the JOURNAL. He eyes the date of the last entry, October 23, the week before. He opens the DESK drawer and carefully places the JOURNAL in it. Muffled SOUNDS come from UPSTAIRS. Steve-O runs UPSTAIRS fearing the worst has happened to his friends. He tracks the SOUNDS to a DOOR, he throws it open. We SEE Matt and Cindy rolling around on a BED half-naked. Steve-O shrinks away as he realizes he’s caught them in the middle.

STEVE-O

Get dressed you guys, we’ve got to get the hell out of here!

MATT

Why?

Cindy

Yeah, go away Steve-O.

STEVE-O

No, I’m serious, we’ve got to find Alex, he’s in trouble.

MATT

Did you hear her, go away! (They go back to themselves.)

STEVE-O

Get up! It has to do with Dagon.

MATT

(They break) What do you mean?

STEVE-O

It's active again and very close to putting the amulet back together, Alex has the last piece.

MATT

Yeah?

STEVE-O

And Alex's stepfather...(pause, whispering) and Alex's stepfather is the one who's been killing around here the past few months.

MATT

Right, how do you know all this?

STEVE-O

My dad's a cop, I've got an inside line on all this stuff. Besides, Tom's journal is right downstairs, come on, you can see.....

The front DOOR slams and heavy FOOTSTEPS are heard on the STAIRS. Steve-O's face freezes and Matt and Cindy are motionless.

STEVE-O

I think we're in big trouble.

Steve-O looks around the room and spies a WINDOW. He rushes over to it and looks down, they are two stories up. The FOOTSTEPS grow louder as they approach the TOP of the STAIRS. Steve-O goes over and quietly closes the bedroom DOOR. He then goes over and opens the WINDOW. Matt joins him.

MATT

There's no way in hell we're going to be able to make it all the way down, we must be at least two stories up.

The FOOTSTEPS indicate the FIGURE is coming closer as he ascends the stairs, Cindy starts whimpering.

MATT

For God's sake, be quiet.

Steve-O tries to wiggle his way out the WINDOW.

MATT

What are you doing?

STEVE-O

I'm not staying in here, I'd rather kill myself in the fall.

The bedroom DOOR is thrown open and Tom is facing them. He is wearing a neat suit and tie looks confusedly at the three of them in the ROOM. His TONE is very confident and even.

MATT

Hello, Mr. Beledire.

TOM

What are you guys doing here?

Steve-O climbs back in the WINDOW.

STEVE-O

(Nervously) We just came up to look for Alex.

TOM

Yeah, so have I. He's supposed to be grounded. Do you know where he is?

MATT

No, we have no idea Mr. Beledire.

TOM

(Eyeing Cindy, she flinches) Well, I think you'd better leave.

MATT

Yes, sir.

Matt and Cindy quickly get dressed. Steve-O and Tom exchange nervous glances. The three of them slowly walk down the STAIRS. Tom follows behind. Steve-O keeps looking back to check on Tom. They exit the HOUSE to Steve-O's CAR.

TOM

Are you sure you guys haven't seen Alex?

MATT

(More confidently) Like we said before, we haven't seen him.

Steve-O gets very nervous.

TOM

Well, that's too bad, I did like you guys. (He pulls out a gun.) But things just can't work out the way we want them to.

Tom SHOOTS Matt and Cindy repeatedly. He turns to Steve-O who's frozen from fright.

TOM

Shouldn't have been reading my papers. When anyone does it only leads to disaster.

Steve-O turns to run but Tom SHOOTS him repeatedly in the back. Steve-O screams and falls. The ECHO from the shots cascades across the hillside. The CAMERA takes slide pictures of the TREES, GRASSES, LEAVES as the NOISE continually ECHOES.

Cut to:

Ben in the RAVINE. Ben is snapped out of his unconsciousness in the small RAVINE by the ECHO of the shots. He is still groggy.

Cut to:

Alex running, listening to the ECHOES. He reaches the RAVINE Ben has fallen into. As Alex jumps across it, he SEES Ben. He squats behind Ben and reaches his HAND out to touch him.

Cut to:

Ben's FACE, pain-stricken, afraid, and tired. A HAND is seen reaching for his shoulder. As it grabs him, he yells and whirls his head and shoulders around. He is still screaming as he SEES Alex.

ALEX

Ahhh!!!! (They scream simultaneously)

BEN

Fuck! (Breathing heavily) Asshole!

ALEX

(Also breathing heavily) Sorry.

BEN

(He tries to get up) Did you hear those...

ALEX

The shots? Yeah.

BEN

This is too much, I can't handle it anymore. What's going to happen to us?

ALEX

(Stands and leans over) I wish to hell I knew.

BEN

Me too...(Gets a gleam in his eye) Hey! Why did you leave me?

ALEX

I panicked. I'm sorry.

BEN

Just don't do it again.

ALEX

I won't. I promise. (He looks around the area. NIGHTFALL is approaching.) C'mon

Ben, we've gotta keep moving.

BEN

Okay, let me rest a minute.

ALEX

No, we've really gotta go.

BEN

Why right this minute?

ALEX

We don't want to be caught out here when it gets dark...c'mon, you don't want me to leave you, do you?

BEN

You said the magic word. I'm moving.

Alex helps Ben to his feet. They move toward the crest of the hill.

BEN

Why are we moving up the hill instead of toward your house?

ALEX

We have to get to the old De la Poer mansion at the top.

BEN

You're crazy. Let me go! Why the De la Poer place? What the hell is there?

ALEX

The answer to this. (Alex grabs the AMULET around his neck and displays it to Ben.)

BEN

Oh. (Looks around) I guess I should go with you. Best to go with the trip, rather than fighting it. I just hope that rock of yours can keep us safe.

ALEX

(Takes a long uncertain breath.) Don't worry, it will.

Ben and Alex walk away from the camera. CAMERA pulls back and a DARK FIGURE is hiding behind a TREE watching them walk away.

Cut to:

Police cars speeding through the city. Follow and focus in on Mike Dannon's CAR, Mike is driving. The police RADIO is on.

RADIO VOICE

We should arrive in 15 minutes. Over.

MIKE

(Picks up the receiver) Negative. Those kids might not have that long. Dispatch, phone the Preston's on 157 Windsor's Peak Road. Contact me as to their situation.

Over.

DISPATCH (RADIO VOICE)

Roger.

DAILY

Don't worry Mike, everything's okay.

MIKE

(Looks at Daily) I hope you're right.

DAILY

My son, Steve, has been in trouble before, and he usually turns out all right...sometimes.

(Laughs)

MIKE

Ben's not a bad seed, he just hangs out with the wrong kids.

DAILY

Yeah. Sometimes I think Steve's the same way.

MIKE

But you know me, I worry. That if he keeps on going like he has that maybe one day he'll turn up dead. Ever think that about Steve?

DAILY

(Pause) No,.....not really. (Looks disdainfully out the window) But maybe I should start before it's too late...

DISPATCH (RADIO VOICE)

That's a negative car fourteen. No answer at the Preston house.

Mike turns and glares at Daily who's looking pensive.

Cut to:

Ben and Alex making their way up Windsor's Peak. Ben has resumed limping, dragging his LEG which is making a distinct trail behind him.

ALEX

Hurry up, Ben, we haven't much time. What happened to the splint?

BEN

A great job that one, Totally trashed my balls. Tell me something. Do you really know why we're going up there? I mean, I'm in quite a bit of pain here.

ALEX

You're fine. I can leave you somewhere if you can't make it.

Alex pauses and does not elaborate. Ben looks ahead.

BEN

Nah, I'm going with you. Some freaky shit back there in the forest. Someone's there.

ALEX

It's this whole amulet thing. This piece is part of a greater whole which, I gather, is very dangerous if assembled. At first I thought I was trippin' and making the whole thing up but now I know the truth.

BEN

You ARE tripping!

ALEX

(Not heard Ben) To tell you the truth, I don't know if I'm trippin' or just scared to

death.

BEN

Another one of our twisted adventures, then.

ALEX

Yeah, sure. But I regret it all.

BEN

Taking drugs or the amulet?

ALEX

(Laughs) No, I don't hate either of them, just the situation..... (stares off)

BEN

What?

ALEX

(Looks at Ben then fixes his eyes ahead) Oh, it's just something my father told me when he was still alive.

BEN

I'm listening.

ALEX

My father told me when he gave me this (he holds the amulet) that things would happen and I would have to protect it, that someone would come looking for it. He said it would protect me.

Cut to:

A VISION of the past. Alex's father giving young Alex the amulet fragment. He's putting it around his NECK.

ALEX (V.O.)

Protect it and it will protect me. (Repeat VISION of Alex's father putting the amulet fragment around young Alex's NECK.)

Cut to:

Alex walking up the hill, Ben LIMPING behind him. They are nearing the mansion.

BEN

Man, what a wreck. Do we really have to go in there?

ALEX

(Smiles) Yeah, we gotta do this. And I should've figured that shifty bastard Tom would be behind all this. You know he dresses nice and my mom always said he was kind but I would look into his eyes and...I just knew there was a lot more to him.

BEN

I just hope we don't run into him.

ALEX

Neither do I. But then again...

Alex stops abruptly.

BEN

What is it?

ALEX

Shhh. I thought I heard something. Did you hear that?

Sound of crunching LEAVES. As soon as it begins, the NOISE stops.

BEN

What the hell are we gonna do?

ALEX

(Confidently) C'mon.

They continue their ascent. Alex takes Ben by his ARM. As they climb over some fallen LOGS, the MANSION comes into full view. Alex looks up, CAMERA on his EYES as they try to focus on a distant OBJECT.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: CAMERA looking up at the MANSION, Francis is seen. He waves to the CAMERA. He motions for the CAMERA (Alex) to come forward. Francis

turns and disappears.

Cut to:

3rd person camera view: Alex and Ben continue moving but now much faster, since Alex is pulling him along. CAMERA on Ben's leg being dragged and the trail it's creating. More crunching NOISES.

BEN

He's following us, he's been fucking following us the whole time. I'm slowing you down. He's gonna catch us. (He looks behind him and CAMERA switches. Tom is seen far behind making his way up the HILL.)

ALEX

In here.

Alex shoves Ben into a THICKET. He falls in and hits his HEAD on a LOG, reopening some of the wound incurred in the ACCIDENT. Fresh BLOOD trickles down his FACE. Alex kneels by him, crunching LEAVES are heard.

ALEX

(To Ben.) Sorry, pal, can't do much dragging you around.

The WIND picks up, the crunching NOISE stops. Alex leans to look out. Nothing is SEEN.

ALEX

He's on our trail thanks to you.

Alex finds his way out and stands facing the MANSION.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: A series of IMAGES assaults Alex's MIND: The burning of the CHURCH, the screams of the ROBED MEN, the AMULET, his FATHER giving him the fragment at the CAMPGROUND.

Cut to:

3rd person camera view: Alex grabs the AMULET about his NECK. The CAMERA is

fixed behind Alex as he walks off toward the MANSION.

Cut to:

Police CARS racing up Windsor's Peak Road, they are passing TREES and HOUSES.

Cut to:

CAMERA on a TREE swaying in the brisk BREEZE. The WIND speeds up and hushed, mumbling voices ECHO through the TREE as if the TREE was uttering the VOICES. Pull CAMERA down and focus on Alex as he nears the MANSION.

1st person camera view: We SEE Francis. He walks toward Alex with an outstretched HAND. He stops. The dilapidated De la Poer MANSION looms in the background.

FRANCIS

You know why you've come to this place?

3rd person camera view:

ALEX

I think so.

FRANCIS

This was the home the piece of amulet you possess rested at for many a year. Your father dug it up and kept it safe. Now you must follow in his footsteps and do the same.

Crunching LEAVES are heard. Alex turns to look in the direction of the NOISE. When he turns back, Francis has vanished. The WIND blows fiercely and creates a small cyclone of LEAVES which encompass Alex. He SPEAKS to whoever will hear.

ALEX

What? Tell me more!!!

The LEAVES blind Alex, he shields his EYES and can no longer see. As soon as the cyclone starts, it ceases.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: CAMERA pans around as the last LEAVES flutter by. He notices he's near the burnt-out CHURCH.

Cut to:

3rd person camera view: CAMERA pulls back and Alex is dressed in 19th century clothes exactly like Francis had before. Alex walks into the CHURCH through the DOOR. It is quiet as he paces toward the center where a charred ALTAR is seen. Suddenly a YOUNG WOMAN grabs his ARM. She is wearing a flowing brown dress of the same period as Alex's clothes. She has a heavy English accent.

YOUNG WOMAN

Please, Mister Preston, he was such a good man. He didn't deserve to die. They killed him.

Alex gazes down at her and shakes her off. He fixes his eyes on the altar.

YOUNG WOMAN (O.S.)

They killed him so he could tell of his journey to the world of the dead. Only you have the power to bring him back to me.

Alex looks at the AMULET fragment. It is emitting a feeble glow. The young woman utters a shrill laugh. Alex looks at the black ALTAR that now has a shrouded BODY upon it. Three ROBED MEN (1st, 2nd, and 3rd ROBED MEN) walk to the ALTAR.

Cut to:

Police stopping at Ben's smashed CAR against the TREE—the DOORS are ajar. Mike get out of his police CAR.

MIKE

What the hell?!

He looks inside and sees some drops of BLOOD on the upholstery. He reaches in and places his fingers in the dried blood.

MIKE

Ben's in trouble.

He gets back into his CAR and continues up the mountain road to Alex's HOUSE. Another car chases after him.

Cut to:

Alex walking up the AISLE. He stares at one of the ROBED MEN. He raises his ARMS and mumbles in Latin.

1st ROBED MAN

Cum spiritus acrebus. Donna eis requiem aeternam.

The AMULET around Alex's NECK is glowing much more brilliantly now.

1st ROBED MAN

Kyrie, elaison! Flammis acrebus addictus! (He stretches his ARMS out.) Requiem aeternam donna eis, Domine! Oh, my son, only you can bring this poor soul back. With only your help can he be brought back to tell of his extensive journey to the underworld. Without you I can do nothing.

ALEX

(Swallows hard) Wh...who is it?

The 1st robed man SMILES.

1st ROBED MAN

Have a look, my son.

Alex leans over the feet of the BODY. He reaches out to pull the SHROUD back.

Cut to:

CAMERA looking at Alex from the ROBED MAN'S point-of-view. Alex is looking down at the BODY and the Young Woman comes up behind him. She peers over Alex's SHOULDER. She kisses him on the NECK and whispers to him.

YOUNG WOMAN

Welcome, dear Alex, there is nothing but love for you here.

She draws away from him. Alex is frozen staring down at the BODY. He gets himself together and tightens his grip on the SHROUD. He looks up at the three ROBED MEN who are SMILING.

Cut to:

1st person camera view: The SHROUD is pulled back toward the CAMERA. The face from the VISION is on the burnt ALTAR. It's EYES crackle open and it quickly sits up

and grabs Alex by the SHOULDERS. The CAMERA goes dark. A voice is heard—it's Francis.

FRANCIS (V.O.)

You must keep the amulet at all costs.

3rd person camera view: Alex is sitting against a WALL of the burnt-out CHURCH near a PEW. The AMULET is glowing very brightly. He SEES three ROBED MEN huddled around the ALTAR. The CHURCH is now new—as it would have been SEEN in 1836.

1st ROBED MAN

Come (He motions to Alex), we must begin, we haven't much time.

Alex slowly stands up and walks down the AISLE. He notices that there are many people sitting in the PEWS. He paces past them looking around dazed, and he slowly approaches the ALTAR. The AMULET is throbbing at his CHEST. He stops at the feet of the shrouded BODY. The ROBED MEN step back from the HEAD and one holds the pieced together (four pieces) AMULET above his head.

1st ROBED MAN

Only one last piece, my Lord, then all will be right in your name. (To Alex) Hand me the last piece of the amulet to me, my son. (He reaches out to Alex.)

Cut to:

Screeching wheels of a police CAR. Mike and Daily sees Steve-O's car and the bodies near the front. Daily jumps out and looks at the three bodies.

MIKE

(Squeezes his FOREHEAD) Dear God!

DAILY

My son!

Mike makes his way to the ajar front door of Alex's HOUSE. A second police CAR screeches to a halt.

OFFICERS

Sir, we have a situation here.

MIKE

You stay with Daily (pointing to one officer) and you come with me.

Cut to:

Alex is covering the AMULET with his hand. The glowing light can be seen through his HAND.

1st ROBED MAN

My son, you must. It is your destiny. It is in your blood.

FRANCIS (V.O.)

Keep the amulet at all costs.

1st ROBED MAN

If not then....(he points to the door behind Alex. Alex slowly turns and Tom enters the CHURCH.)

TOM

Alex! The amulet!

Tom approaches Alex with a GUN in his HAND. Alex begins to shake.

ALEX

You will not perform this damned ceremony! Damn you all! You think you're doing the right things? How wrong you....ahh, I get it, this is a test! This isn't real at all. I'm trippin' just like all the times before. In fact, I bet I'm still sitting in the car when I hit the tree.

TOM

Alex, kid, are you really that naive to believe this is not happening? I'm just as much here as you are. (He puts the GUN in his pocket, massages his FIST and hits Alex in the side. Alex winces.) Did you feel that? By the looks of things, I'd guess yes.

Believe me Alex, you're here.

ALEX

No, I'm not. This is not happening.

TOM

(Pacing up and down the aisle of the CHURCH.)

I feel so....my family was nearly eradicated by your family's efforts. We were nearly made extinct. Think of it, living in fear, not being able to enjoy life like normal people. Just because my ancestor some 160 years ago did what he believed, your family tracked his descendants down....like dogs.

Now revenge is mine. You're going to go through with this Alex whether you like it or not. You're going to feel the pain, the fear of having to watch over your shoulder, the loss of watching your family members being slaughtered one by one.

(He turns and faces Alex.) You're going to do it Alex!!

The amulet fragment is throbbing violently at Alex's chest.

ALEX

(Shaking his HEAD) I can't and I won't.

TOM

(Pacing) That's too bad. Your friend will have never lived.

ALEX

Who?

TOM

Steve Daily. I'm sure you know who he is.

ALEX

What do you mean?

TOM

Have a look. (He extends his ARM toward the shrouded BODY on the ALTAR.)

Alex starts to pull the SHROUD back. CAMERA focuses on the HEAD as the cloth is removed. It is Steve-O.

TOM

You see, I caught him snooping on my journal, reading how and why I killed those families. I had no choice, I really didn't want to kill him.....not really....but let's say, circumstances persuaded me to. Why I couldn't be discovered now could I Alex. We couldn't have ol' dad in jail, could we now?

ALEX

You're not my father. And that's not Steve-O, and none of this is happening!

TOM

On the contrary, Alex, this all is real...(walking toward Alex) and believe me that is Steve-O. About the father part, yeah, I'm not your real father but that's another story. (He puts his ARM around Alex) And since I'm not your REAL father as you put it, I shouldn't pay any special attention to you. (Increases the volume of his VOICE) Now, put the amulet together!!!

ALEX

No, I'm not.....

Tom grabs Alex and HITS him several times in the stomach. He lifts Alex's FACE and yells into it.

TOM

Put the damn amulet together!!

ALEX

(Coughing, wheezing) No.....

Tom hits him a few more times. Alex tries to fight back but Tom is too strong.

TOM

Tough little bastard, aren't you? Think about is Alex. Is it worth dying over?

Alex THORWS a couple of punches, he misses. Tom grabs him and starts CHOKING him.

TOM

Last chance, Alex. All I have to do is squeeze and you won't wake up. Are you going to cooperate? (Tom looks at the three ROBED MEN.)

1st ROBED MAN

Release him. He will not be good to us if he's dead.

Tom lets go of Alex and he falls against Steve-O's body. Tom steps back, straightens his TIE, and fixes his HAIR.

1st ROBED MAN

Come here. (He motions to Alex)

Alex massages his throat and hacks. Tom moves toward him, Alex reels back.

TOM

Do as he says!

The 1st Robed Man motions to Tom waving him off.

1st ROBED MAN

Come here, my son.

Alex turns, eyes the BODY and the 1st Robed Man still holding the pieced together AMULET. Alex grips the AMULET fragment around his NECK and walks over to the 1st Robed Man.

Cut to:

More police CARS arrive. The officers have amassed around the bodies. Mike is comforting Daily.

MIKE

I'm sorry, John.

Daily

(Standing over Steve-O) He was my only son.....(sighs heavily)

An officer comes out of Alex's HOUSE.

OFFICER

Looks like the kids were in the house. No forced entry.

MIKE

Why these kids? I want to talk to Tom Beledire, call in a warrant for his arrest.

(To himself.) I've got to be sure Ben's okay. But it's going to be dark soon. Better get started on the search.

(To the officers.) We're going to have to go out and look for the other kids to see if they're all right and not like....(Pause) Take John back to the station and call the coroner. I want seven men to come with me and search. We'll form parties of two and split up. Comb the mountain around the house as fast as you can and we'll meet at the peak.

The officers talk amongst themselves, several looking shocked.

MIKE

Let's move!

The officers split up and go into the TREES. CAMERA pulls back into the TREES, the WIND is blowing. Daily and another officer are sitting by Steve-O's body.

Cut to:

Alex is next to the 1st Robed Man.

1st ROBED MAN

You see my son, that you have no choice but to help us. Some of the members of our family see violence as the only solution but I believe in logic and reason. Do you understand, Alex?

ALEX

(Still rubbing his throat) Yeah. (He hacks.) Yes.

1st ROBED MAN

And you seem like a smart boy. I know you can appreciate the dilemma you're in.

Alex nods not really listening, he's staring at Steve-O trying to decide if it's really him. He still believes he is under the influence of DRUGS. Alex swallows hard and looks at the 1st Robed Man.

1st ROBED MAN

Now.....let us truly begin.....as one light.

Alex pulls the AMULET fragment from his NECK. Tom smiles evilly.

1st ROBED MAN

Kyrie, elaison! My son. (He lays his hand on Alex's HEAD.)

Alex hands the 1st Robed Man the piece of the AMULET. He puts it together and it glows with a fierce, evil supernatural LIGHT. The CONGREGATION which has been silent, begins CHANTING. The 1st Robed Man hands the newly-assembled AMULET to Alex.

1st ROBED MAN

Now, my son, place Dagon on the chest of your sleeping friend, so that he may awaken and tell of his magnificent journeys from beyond.

Alex takes the AMULET and holds it in front of him. The light reflects off his FACE, crowded whispers of voices past assault his EARS—he SMILES through his tear choked FACE. He gazes around at the CONGREGATION, Tom is smiling and nodding. The 1st Robed Man leans over Steve-O's BODY and opens the shirt exposing the chest. He stands back behind Alex.

1st ROBED MAN

Hurry, my son. We haven't much time.

Alex closes his eyes and takes a deep breath; he grips the AMULET firmly. VISIONS of his youth fill his mind, his memories cascade over his senses and his identity falters. VISIONS of Alex and his father making animal traps is SEEN. Alex shooting out an abandoned car's windshield with a .22 rifle is SEEN. A VISION of Alex and his mother, a vision of Christmas past with his mother and father is SEEN. The VISIONS swirl together. He opens his eyes.

Close up on Alex's FACE contorting. The CHANTING is very loud. He turns his uncertain EYES toward the 1st Robed Man behind him. He SMILES and a TEAR runs down his CHEEK. (Slow motion: CU of the TEAR as it runs off Alex's FACE and follow it until it splashes on the stone FLOOR. A crashing SOUND is heard.)

CAMERA on Alex and the Robed Man: normal speed. Alex turns and lunges the sharp AMULET into the CHEST of the 1st Robed Man. The Robed Man hunches over, grimacing. As he does so, Alex hits him squarely in the face with his KNEE. The 1st

Robed Man keels back and falls flat. The CONGREGATION is on its feet and the 2nd and 3rd Robed Men have moved back. Alex madly turns to the CONGREGATION.

ALEX

Kyrie, elaison! (He laughs heartily) Whatever! I'm trippin' man, the best trip ever!

Alex bounds over the 1st Robed Man who is still alive. Alex's eyes are wide with insanity. He leans over him, grabs the glowing AMULET and digs it around the Robed Man's stomach and abdomen. The Robed Man screams in excruciating pain. Alex is breathing deeply and quickly. He yanks the blood-stained AMULET out of the 1st Robed Man. He turns and raises the amulet to the CONGREGATION. Tom stands frozen, as a STATUE.

ALEX

Now.....it's my turn....

The WINDOWS of the CHURCH shatter and PEOPLE burst through them. Alex lowers the AMULET and quickly looks around. He finds Tom and fixes his gaze upon him. They stare at each other unaffected by what is going on around them.

Cut to:

CAMERA behind Tom looking at Alex. Francis climbs in a window, stops and looks at Alex. He smiles broadly and yells at Alex's back.

FRANCIS

Thank you Alex, our eternal battle is over, we may now rest in peace.

FIRES are lit. (CLOSE UP of Alex's face.) We SEE the light reflecting off Alex's FACE. FLAMES quickly engulf the CHURCH. The CONGREGATION is attacked by the POEPL. CAMERA PAN (360 degrees) around Alex and Tom as the scene is unfolding. Tom breaks his stare with Alex, turns and runs out the door. Alex looks at the AMULET and places it on the stone FLOOR. He smashes it under his SHOE and starts to run out. He stops and looks back at the ALTER.

QUIET.

The scene has changed. We SEE Alex is dressed as previously and the CHURCH is a ruined shell. There are no fires, no bodies, and no screams, just an eerie prevailing

SILENCE echoed with a far distant THUNDERCLAP.

Alex swallows hard and looks at his HANDS—no blood. He runs his fingers through his hair and sees something reflecting light near the ALTAR. He paces toward the small OBJECT on the FLOOR. He bends down to pick it up. It's the piece of AMULET still attached to a broken chain which had been around his NECK. Alex picks up the AMULET and closes his HAND around it. He turns and runs out of the CHURCH.

Cut to:

The OFFICERS nearing the THICKET where Ben is lying.

Cut to:

Ben inside of the THICKET just beginning to regain consciousness. Crunching LEAVES are heard. Ben rubs the back of his NECK, the dried blood comes off in his HANDS.

BEN

Alex?

He manages to get up and crawl his way through the THICKET.

Cut to:

Tom being chased by Alex, it is twilight. The MANSION comes into sight, Tom runs toward it. He looks back and sees Alex chasing after him. Tom picks up his pace.

TOM

Just try to catch me.....Alex.....No one has so far!

He laughs which quickly turns into a moan of fatigue. He runs past the MANSION.

Cut to:

CAMERA fixed looking at the darkening SKY and the MANSION as it looms in the background. A couple flashes of LIGHTNING illuminate the SKY. We SEE Tom running past the CAMERA. Wait a few seconds, we SEE Alex running the same path. We SEE that Alex has managed to catch up to Tom.

Cut to:

Tom running through the WOODS, his SHIRT has come untuck and his TIE has been

loosened. He has discarded his JACKET. He passes the THICKET where Ben has crawled out moments before. He SEES the Preston HOUSE and runs down the HILL toward it. He stops and sees two officers walking up the HILL. He looks about him and runs a different direction to avoid the officers. He runs into a CLEARING surrounded by thick bushes on both sides and a deep RAVINE prohibiting any further progress. He looks perplexedly at his predicament and turns to run back. Alex comes into the CLEARING.

ALEX

You'll never escape.

TOM

What do you plan to do? (Panting) Kill me?

ALEX

If necessary.

TOM

Listen to yourself.....you sound so goddamned melodramatic.

ALEX

(Looking confused) What the hell?

TOM

You really did it back there, at the church. Do you even know what you did?

ALEX

No, but I have a feeling you're going to tell me.

TOM

You've erased any chances of revitalization. You've broken a chain considered unbreakable.

ALEX

Damn straight. You shouldn't have fucked with me.

TOM

(Looks around, smirks. It is nearly dark.) Remember the good times we had together?
How I used to take care of you? How you never took me in as your father? It hurt, no
matter what I did you never liked me.

ALEX

(Looking almost remorseful)that's not.....not true.....

TOM

Yes it is and you know it. I couldn't help what I was destined to do just as you couldn't
escape it. I hated what I did. The amulet made me do it, I'm innocent. That damned
amulet, it's so hypnotic. It made me do what it wanted me to.

Alex opens his HAND and looks down at the AMULET, it starts to glow. Alex gets
wide-eyed and stares at Tom. Crunching LEAVES are heard in the distance.

ALEX

I think you're lying, Tom.

TOM

Perhaps. (Tom takes a step back toward the RAVINE not looking where he's going.)

Cut to:

Two officers looking into a THICKET.

1st OFFICER

(To the 2nd Officer) We'd better turn back, it's almost dark.

2nd OFFICER

(Looks up at the SKY) We won't be able to do much more around here until daybreak.
Crunching LEAVES are heard. The sound as if someone's dragging something heavy.

1st OFFICER

Hear that? (The NOISE increases; approaches them.)

2nd OFFICER

Yeah. (They walk toward the NOISE. Ben comes out from behind a TREE.) Ben!
The officers run over to Ben and attend him.

1st OFFICER

We've been searching the entire area for you, your father's worried sick about you.

2nd OFFICER

(Looks at Ben. He SEES the dried BLOOD and his mangled ANKLE) Are you OK?

BEN

I guess so. Where's dad?

1st OFFICER

Let me radio him. (Pulls a WALKIE-TALKIE from his waist.) Chief Dannon, this is
O'Hara, come in.

VOICE FROM RADIO (MIKE)

Dannon here, what you got?

1st OFFICER

We found Ben. He seems a little worse for wear but is okay.

MIKE (FROM RADIO)

What is your position?

1st OFFICER

We're due south of the peak, near the old mansion.

BEN

Alex.

1st OFFICER

(To radio) Just a minute. (To Ben) What? What is it?

BEN

Alex, he is in great danger. (Ben starts walking off.)

1st OFFICER

(Follows Ben) Hold on! (2nd Officer chases after Ben. 1st Officer to radio.) We're
moving due west.

MIKE (FROM RADIO)

Copy. We're moving east and will meet up with you. Out.

Cut to:

Alex and Tom facing each other. Tom is slowly backing away from Alex, Alex is closing the distance.

ALEX

You want this don't you? (He hold up the glowing AMULET.) You think you can still put the whole thing together, huh?

TOM

You don't miss a beat, kid.

Alex smiles broadly and dangles the AMULET before his FACE. He drops the amulet in the tall GRASS at his FEET.

ALEX

Come and get it, it wants you.

TOM

Don't tempt me.

Alex takes a stance over the AMULET. He waves his fingers his direction taunting him. Tom lunges at Alex and they struggle. Alex hits Tom, Tom hits back. He tries to choke Alex but since he's so fatigued, Alex has the strength to throw him off. They stand facing each other.

ALEX

It's too bad it has to end like this.

Tom laughs and straightens up. He is visibly tired.

TOM

Yeah. For you. (He laughs)

Alex yells and dives into his stomach.

Cut to:

Two officers looking into the TREES.

Cut to:

The officers with Mike.

MIKE

That sounded like Alex! C'mon!

Cut to:

Ben with the 1st and 2nd Officers.

BEN

Alex! (Tries to run)

Cut to:

Alex is thrown down by Tom. He's hurt. He tries to get up—a large BRANCH is near his side. Tom hovers over him.

TOM

Just stay down Alex, it's not worth it. (He turns and reaches for the AMULET fragment in the GRASS.)

ALEX

Yes it is.

Alex jumps up wielding the BRANCH. He hits Tom a couple of times with it and he falls over. Alex kicks Tom in the side. Tom grabs Alex by the ankle and knocks him down. Tom slowly gets up and stands over Alex again.

TOM

Don't. Don't make me have to kill you.

Tom looms over a beat Alex. Alex is facing toward the CAMERA away from Tom. He tenses his face, grabs the branch and hits Tom across the midsection. Alex pushes Tom toward the RAVINE. Alex clamors up and stands over the AMULET. He bends down and picks it up. Tom looks at it and the AMULET starts glowing again. He backs closer to the edge of the RAVINE.

ALEX

You want it? (Motioning with the AMULET) You want it?

Tom backs to the very edge of the RAVINE. He stops just short of falling off the edge. He puts a sinister smile across his face as he stares at the AMULET. Pulls out the GUN from his pocket and points it at Alex.

TOM

Well here we are.

ALEX

You killed all of them didn't you?

Tom nods.

ALEX

Those people. Mr. Gilman.

CLOSE UP of Mr. Gilman floating in his HOT TUB.

ALEX

.....Steve-O.

CLOSE UP of Steve-O lying bloody near his CAR.

TOM

And others....

CLOSE UP of Matt and Cindy lying near Steve-O's CAR. Alex looks around nervously. He hears some people approaching.

ALEX

(Looks at the glowing AMULET) All for the amulet?

TOM

(Nods and smiles) Yes, give it to me. (The gun quivers in his HAND. He extends his other HAND.)

Alex half-smiles and motions.

ALEX

I hope you choke on it.

Slow motion: Alex tosses the amulet to Tom. CAMERA tracks the AMULET cascading through the air, the glow is unnatural. It is closing in on Tom, he steps back just a bit. He's teetering on the edge of the RAVINE.

Cut to:

The officers and Ben are closing in. They appear in the CLEARING while the AMULET is in mid-air.

CLOSE UP of Tom's FACE as the AMULET approaches him. The GLOW from the AMULET illuminates his FACE and he realizes he has to step back to catch it. He extends his ARM and peers up at the AMULET.

CAMERA behind Tom as he's reaching. CLOSE UP of his HAND as it grabs the AMULET. It GLOWS fiercely.

CAMERA in front of Tom. He has the AMULET in his HAND while losing his balance on the EDGE of the RAVINE. Tom falls off the EDGE—back first.

CAMERA from the side of Tom falling. He falls down the RAVINE and lands on the BOTTOM. CLOSE UP of his HEAD sharply striking a STONE. Tom's FACE contorts. The AMULET and GUN are dislodged from his HANDS.

CAMERA view of Tom's BODY from the EDGE of the RAVINE. Alex walks over and peers down at Tom. The officers are in the CLEARING. Mike approaches Alex and looks down the RAVINE at Tom's BODY. CLOSE UP of Alex's frozen FACE.

MIKE (O.S.)

It's over Alex.

CAMERA on Alex's face. He starts to break down. He presses his HANDS on his EARS and begins squeezing his HEAD. He lets out a horrible shriek.

Cut to:

Ben limping into the CLEARING. Mike sees him and leaves Alex. The scream is still ECHOING as they embrace.

MIKE

Ben, are you okay?

BEN

Yeah.

Ben breaks away from Mike and LIMPS over to Alex. Mike grabs him by the ARM.

MIKE

Don't, son. It's not pretty.

BEN

Don't worry. I've seen my share today.

Ben breaks away from Mike and walks over to Alex who's still looking down at Tom. The AMULET stops glowing. Ben reaches Alex and stands directly behind him. As he's about to touch Alex, Alex scrambles down the RAVINE, scoops up the AMULET fragment and climbs back up. He sees Ben.

BEN

You okay?

Alex looks at Ben with starry EYES. They embrace.

Cut to:

Alex and Ben embracing.

ALEX

(Looks off and raises the AMULET. Gets wide-eyed.) Steve-O!!

Alex runs down the hillside toward his HOUSE. Ben LIMPS past Mike and the officers and catches up with Alex.

We SEE Alex kneeling over Steve-O's body. He strokes his HEAD and rubs his cheek.

ALEX

It was true, I could have saved you.

Ben comes up behind Alex and stands over him. Alex holds up the AMULET, it is glowing. Alex smiles.

ALEX

Is it true? Can it be possible?

BEN

Alex, please, let's go.

ALEX

It is possible.....

Alex rubs Steve-O's head, stares at the fiercely glowing AMULET and places it on Steve-O's chest. He covers the AMULET with his HAND and closes his EYES. Ben yanks at Alex's shoulder.

BEN

Alex...

Alex looks at Ben and smiles. Ben helps him up. They walk together toward Alex's HOUSE. Mike and the officers come down the hill to meet them.

CAMERA on level just behind Steve-O's BODY looking at the glowing AMULET. The supernatural LIGHT pulses and fades. We SEE the group walking off in the distance. The wind picks up and LIGHTNING illuminates the dark sky.

ALEX

I think I'll go to bed now.

BEN

That sounds like a good idea.

Cut to:

Alex waking in his bed. He is sweating and visibly shaken. He looks around his ROOM which is pitch dark.

ALEX

Man, what a trip. I'm not taking drugs again.

Alex goes to the WINDOW and peers out into the darkness. LIGHTNING streaks across the sky. He reaches for his PHONE and dials Ben. After it rings several times, Ben answers, woken from sleep.

BEN

Yeah, what's up?

ALEX

I just had the most fucked up dream.

BEN

What..?

ALEX

Were you sleeping?

BEN

No. (His tone is sarcastic) Really?

ALEX

Tell me what happened didn't happen.

BEN

Oh it happened all right. You fucked it up good this time.

LIGHTNING flashes at the WINDOW. Alex peers out, seeing Francis in his back yard.

ALEX

I'm sure it will work itself out.

BEN

Good night. I'll see you in school tomorrow.

Alex closes his PHONE. CAMERA floats past Alex and out the WINDOW. CAMERA moves past TREES moving in the WIND up the hill to the ruined CHURCH. A GLOW emanates from within and a child's LAUGH is heard.

CAMERA FADE OUT.